The Barracks

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Rating:
Mature

Archive Warning:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence

Category:
F/F

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Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Catra & Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Adora & Catra & Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Adora & Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)

Characters:
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Additional Tags:
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The Barracks

by 3AM_Reads

Summary

All the pressure Adora had to endure growing up in the Fright Zone with her only goal being to please Shadow Weaver and become Force Captain. All the emotional trauma and gaslighting Catra had to endure with her only goal being to get some sort of recognition from Shadow Weaver. All the while their love for each other blooming against Shadow Weaver's orders

Chapter 1: Prologue

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Prologue

Adora walked into the Barracks to find Catra sitting on her bunk. Her head was wrapped up in Adora's blanket.

"Hey, it's just me." Adora said as she approached the bed.

When she reached the bed she removed the blanket from Catra's head. Catra hissed with little tears in her eyes. Adora sat on the bed beside her and wrapped an arm around her.

"Hey, you look out for me and I look out for you. Nothing really bad can happen as long as we have each other."

"You promise?"

"I promise. Now let's go back out."

They got up and headed towards the exit of their shared room.

"You look out for me and I look out for you...."

"You promise?"

"I promise."

A promise they both lived by while they were growing up in the Horde together.

Chapter End Notes

Hi I know the prologue was hella short. Honestly I had no idea. Anyways if you have any comments or questions you can add me on Instagram Catrasboobwindow

Chapter 2: The Beginning

Chapter Summary

> The first time Adora and Catra met. Also how Catra got her name.

The Beginning

From the moment Shadow Weaver laid her eyes on baby Adora, she knew she was destined for nothing but greatness. Hordak being the fool he was didn't even give the baby a second glance. But Shadow Weaver, she vowed to mold Adora into the best force captain in all of Horde.

Adora always understood why Shadow Weaver put so much pressure on her. She had to be the best. She had to train harder than anyone else in the Horde. She knew Shadow Weaver had a plan for her. She couldn't get distracted. She had to stay focus if she wanted to be the best of the best. But there was always something about Catra, that she could never avoid.

From the day she met Catra she knew they would have a special bond. She was peaking her little head through Hordak's sanctum. She knew she could get in a lot of trouble for that, but curiosity got the better of her. She saw one of the force captains carrying a box, and just had to know what was in it.

"My lord, you can't truly expect me to make something out of this, this disgusting creature do you? We have Adora and the others, I see no future in training such a beast." Shadow Weaver said, as she looked down at the box.

"Are you questioning my orders? I did not make you my second in command for you to question my decisions." Hordak said, digging his nails into the arms of his throne. He was growing tired of the conversation.

"So I advise you to see my orders through or you will will no longer have a purpose to me." Just as he finished his sentence a little head popped out of the box.

"KITTY!!" Adora said, as she ran towards the box.

Shadow Weaver looked down as Adora reached the box. She grabbed her arm before she could touch the creature inside. She pulled her to the side and out of Hordak's view.

"Adora," she said in a hushed tone." what are you doing in here? You know you are not allowed in here, especially during one of my meetings."

"Shadow Weaver, if you can not keep your soldiers in check, then perhaps I find someone who can." He slammed his hand on the arm of his throne.

"No my lord. I will handle this and ensure that this does not happen again." She said, as she gestured for Adora to grab the box. They walked out into the hallway. Adora put the box down and opened it. A little kitty's head popped out. Adora helped the kitten out of the box by grab one of her tiny hands.

"Just make sure that creature stays out of trouble. You can take her back to the barracks." Shadow Weaver looked down at the two children holding hands as they headed towards the barracks in disgusted.

The two children reached the quarters. Hands still gripping on to each other's. Adora walked her to her bunk with excitement.

"This is my bunk. Since no one sleeps on the top one you can have it." Adora said, pointing at the top bunk above hers. Catra looked at the bunk above Adora's. As she attempted to climb the ladder to the top bunk, three other cadets made their way into the barracks.

"Guys," Adora said as the three cadets made their way to their own bunks. "This is..." She turned to Catra with a confused face.

"Hey, what is your name anyways?"

Catra looked at the girl and then looked down.

"I know I'll call you Catra, because you look like a cat and ra because my name ends with ra." She said with a smile so big that it exposed all the gaps from her missing teeth.

The three cadets crowded around her to greet her. Catra felt like she had a place where she could be her.

Chapter 3: Realization

Chapter Summary

Catra realized that no matter how hard she tried she'll never get any type of praise from Shadow Weaver, which causes a little argument between her and Adora.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Realization

Catra realized that she was different from the other cadets from the very beginning. She notice that they all had two eyes that were the same color. She noticed that they didn't have sharp claws and pointy ears (expect for a certain green lizard). She noticed they didn't have a tail that would betray them when they were scared or worried. She noticed they didn't have sharp teeth, and despite all of this Adora still loved her.

Catra knew that as long as Adora loved her, nothing else matter. As long as Adora was there, wanting to be around her, she didn't care what anyone else thought. The other cadets didn't understand Catra the way Adora did. The other cadets saw her as a freak, as someone who would never fit in with them. But Catra tried not to dwell on that because as long as she had Adora she felt like she had everything she needed.

But sometimes Catra did dwell on it. She thought about how Adora was able to become friends with anyone she came in contact with. She thought about how Shadow Weaver would never love her the way she loved Adora. How she would never be good enough to gain her respect, no matter how hard she tried.

During training Catra tried her best to please Shadow Weaver. Most times Catra could beat Adora, because of her cat like features, it was easier for her to run through the courses better than most of the other cadets. She would usually have the fastest times. She was able to take out more bots during training than anyone else. And when it came to combat training she knew how to take down her opponent. And despite all of this, Shadow Weaver never gave her praise for her achievements. Instead it was always Adora being praised, even when she came in second.

"Adora, great job today. I see a lot of improvement after your last training session." Shadow Weaver said one afternoon as training was wrapping up.

"I see you're taking training very seriously, unlike some other cadets." She said, as she gave Catra a death glare.

"I don't understand how a creature like you can manage to come in first during training and not know how to follow a simple order. You were supposed to work as a team, Catra. But as usual you went off and did whatever you wanted." Shadow Weaver said, looking at the tween.

"Urgg, whatever. We still managed to take down all the bots in a decent amount of time. If you ask me, I'd say that's a win." Catra said, smirking at Shadow Weaver.

"Yes, well how can you expect to make force captain one day if all you do is disobey direct orders? Not that you'd ever be given the opportunity." She said, as she stared at the younger girl. Catra felt her anger start to boil up.

"Whatever." She said, as she walked out of the training room and towards the locker room. Adora was about to head after her when Shadow Weaver stopped her.

"Adora," Shadow Weaver called. "Do not let her distract you. If you want to make force captain one day, you can't let her drag you down. I see great promise in you, but she makes it hard for

you to stay focused. Do not let her stop you from reaching your full potential." Shadow Weaver said, dismissing her.

By the time Adora entered the locker room Catra was already getting dressed. Catra didn't even look at her as she approached her. She was focused on getting out of there to avoid the obvious conversation they were about to have.

"Catra?" Adora said, as she watched her put her shirt on.

"Catra, come on you can't seriously be mad at me right now. You were the one who was being disrespectful and didn't follow orders." She said, still looking at Catra.

Catra stopped what she was doing to look at Adora.

"Are you serious right now Adora? Why should I listen to her when everything I do is wrong? I can't even breathe without it being a problem for her. I work just as hard as anyone else in this shithold. In fact I work harder just to prove to her that I'm not a complete fuck up."

"Catra, language." Adora said, as she looked at Catra.

"Seriously Adora? You're such people pleaser that you can't even hear someone curse. I bet you've never even cursed before." Catra said with a smile on her face.

"I am not a people pleaser. I just don't like getting in trouble ."

"Oh please, you never get in trouble. Everyone knows that you're Shadow Weaver's favorite. You're her prized possession. You can do no wrong. Meanwhile I'm lucky if she even looks at me without disgust in her eyes." She said, as she headed towards the door.

"Catra, Catra, please don't be mad at me. I didn't want to ruin your night." She said, chasing after her.

"Well it's a little to later for that, isn't it?" She said as she took off running.

Catra knew that if she was caught running she would be in serious trouble, but she had to get away from Adora. Adora would never understand trying to prove yourself when everything was always handed to her.

She ran until she spotted a supply closet. She knew Adora would still be looking for her and would want to try to talk things out, but she wasn't in the mood for talking. She open the supply closet door and made herself comfortable inside. She ended up falling asleep in the closet, missing dinner in the process.

Chapter End Notes

> Hi, Happy Thanksgiving. I decided to post today as a gift to you guys. I guess this chapter isn't that bad. Shadow Weaver is still a huge piece of shit but yea. Also the next chapter isn't that bad either. It's actually kind of cute
>
> Also my sign off is going to be
>
> ~The Guardian

Chapter 4: Bad Side

Chapter Summary

A little cuteness before the dark. Catra and Adora reconcile and have a cute little moment

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Bad Side

Adora felt like complete shit after her fight with Catra. She felt even worse when Catra didn't come to dinner. She figured she was in the barracks, so she decided to sneak a ration bar out of dinner and bring it to her. Sort of like a peace offering, but also, she knew Catra would be starving. So after dinner she headed straight to the barracks expecting Catra to be laying on her bunk. But when she got there Catra was no where to be found.

Now Adora was really freaking out. If Catra wasn't in the barracks, where could she possibly be. Adora knew if Shadow Weaver found out that Catra not only missed dinner but she also wasn't in the barracks she would get in big trouble. So before lights out Adora pretended she was going to sleep. Once the other cadets were sleeping she snuck out to search for Catra.

She checked Catra's usual hiding spot. She climbed to the top of the Frightzone, to where they could see all the way to the Whispering Woods. She looked through the dining hall. She looked through the locker room. She even looked through the showers, but still no Catra. Adora was starting to get worried. Where could she be?

She was starting to get worried. Worried enough to go and ask Shadow Weaver for help. Just as she was turning a corner she

heard a noise coming from a storage closet down the hall. She ran to it and as soon as she opened the door Catra came rolling out.

"Holy shit Catra! I've been looking everywhere for you. You missed dinner and I was worried that Shadow Weaver had done something to you." She said, grabbing her and wrapping her in a tight hug.

"Adora. Adora please.. I can't breathe." Catra said trying to catch her breathe. Although, she would never admit it out loud, the warmth from Adora was very comforting, but how could she experience it again if she died from suffocation.

Adora released her and looked her in her mismatched eyes. She was about to speak when she saw the huge smirk on Catra's face.

"Why are you smirking at me?" She said as she watched Catra. Catra just continued staring at her, the smirk on her face slowly turning into a grin.

"What?!" Adora said, getting slightly annoyed.

"You cursed."

"What?"

"You cursed. You said a bad word. You know what this means?" Catra asked, trying to contain her excitement. Adora shrugged her shoulders.

"This means you're not as good as Shadow Weaver thinks you are. This means you secretly have a bad side." Catra said as she helped Adora to her feet.

"Catra I was really worried about you. You didn't came to dinner and they were giving the good ration bars this time. The gray kind. And I know how much you love that kind." She said as they walked back towards the barracks.

"I'm sorry. I just needed to find somewhere I could be alone. So I could just think and not completely explode." She said as she walked next to the other girl.

"Well here," Adora said as she pulled out the ration bar from her pants. "I know you're hungry and I don't want you to starve to death. Plus if Shadow Weaver finds out I snuck food out of dinner, I'm as good as dead."

Catra took the ration bar from her hands and split it into two. She offered the other half to Adora and then ate her half. They ate them quickly and made their way back to their sleeping quarters. Adora got her bunk ready for her and Catra to sleep in. Catra had gotten used to sleeping with Adora on the bottom bunk. At this point it was an expectation more than an opportunity for the both of them. She climbed in as Adora wrapped her blanket around the both of them.

"I'm sorry that I scared you." Catra said as she cuddled into Adora's side.

"I'm sorry I got you upset to the point where you thought you'd explode." Adora said as she started to rub the top of Catra's head causing her to start purring.

"It wasn't really you if I'm being honest." She said, as she purred and began to drift off to sleep.

Soon the two of them drifted peacefully off to sleep.

Chapter End Notes

> So here's a little happy before the dark. Anyways I'm warning you guys here the next 3 chapters are triggering. I'll have a warning at the beginning and end of the next 3 chapters.
>
> ~The Guardian. Also if you need to talk or have any suggestions add me on Instagram @catrasboobwindow

Chapter 5: Repercussions

Chapter Summary

> The aftermath of Catra missing dinner and Shadow Weaver not being to happy about it.

Chapter Notes

> Alright this chapter is dark. There is child abuse in this chapter. I wanted to warn you ahead of time, that way you aren't surprised. I don't think it's that bad but I still want to let you guys know.
>
> So trigger warning, child abuse

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Repercussions

Catra knew missing dinner would have consequences. Any time Catra did anything that displeased Shadow Weaver she had to suffer the consequences. In the past Catra's actions had gotten her sent to the Black Garnet chamber with Shadow Weaver, and let's just say it's not one of Catra's favorite places to be.

It's not like Catra didn't try to behave, because she did, it was that no matter what she did Shadow Weaver was never pleased. She tried so hard to be a cadet that Shadow Weaver would be proud of. That Shadow Weaver saw potential in. That Shadow Weaver could shape into a strong, reliable force captain.

She was very respectful in the beginning, towards the commanding officers, to the other cadets, to Shadow Weaver, to everyone. But there was never any respect given back. As a result one day when she was around 5 years old she decided it was

better to be mean and disrespectful than it was to be nice and respectful. She figured you give respect to get respect.

The cadets, whether they were older, younger, or the same age, never showed her any type respect. They would make fun of her for being to small or because her eyes were two different colors. They'd pull her tail or push her around, and of course she couldn't do anything because, well they were bigger than her. So she'd fight with them, trying to stand her ground. Trying to show them that she wouldn't be pushed around anymore.

With Shadow Weaver it was different. She couldn't physically harm her, not that she wouldn't have tried, but she figured words could hurt just as bad. The attitude she would give her would definitely have an effect. She figured one way or another Shadow Weaver would see her.

The only person she rarely directed this negativity towards was Adora. Adora was the only person who treated her like an equal. The only person who treated her with respect. And for that she loved Adora deeply. Although sometimes Catra felt like she was second best when it came to Shadow Weaver, she never felt like it when it was just the two of them. But sometimes Adora let her relationship with Shadow Weaver come between her relationship with Catra. Sure she'd try to stand up for her here and there but most of the time Adora just couldn't disobey Shadow Weaver when she was "disciplining" Catra.

As Catra walked into dinning hall, she felt her nerves start to get to her. She knew Shadow Weaver knew she wasn't at dinner after training. What she hoped she didn't know was that she was out of the barracks past lights out. She hoped she didn't know that she was in a storage closet instead. And she especially hoped that she didn't know that her prized prodigy was out looking for her instead of getting a good night's sleep.

Adora must've seen the worry in Catra's eyes, because she grabbed her hand and guided her to a table. She placed her tray on the table and looked around. She searched for those narrow

white eyes, and eventually she found them staring daggers at her. Shadow Weaver's death glare was so intense that Catra didn't dare look up. She stared at her tray until it was time to get ready for training. She rushed out of the dinning hall like her life depended on it, which it kind of did.

Catra knew it was coming. Whether it was before or after training, she knew it was coming. She knew Shadow Weaver wasn't going to let her off the hook. She spent all of training avoiding the woman's gaze. For the first time in a long time Catra followed all of Shadow Weaver's orders. She figured maybe it'll lessen the harshness of the punishment. Sadly this was not the case. After training was over Shadow Weaver pulled Catra to the side as the other cadets exited the training room. Once all the cadets filed out Shadow Weaver grabbed Catra by the arm.

"Do you think I'm a fool Catra?" She said, grasping her arm firmer.

"Did you really think I wouldn't see that you weren't at dinner yesterday? What was so important that you missed dinner Catra? Do you think the rules do not apply to you?" She asked as she started to drag the girl out of the training room and towards the Black Garnet chamber.

"ANSWER ME CHILD" She said, clearly irritated.

Catra knew that no matter what she would still be punished. Whether she answered her or didn't. There was never a right response. So Catra decided not to answer. That earned a firmer grip on her arm.

When they reached the Black Garnet chamber Catra didn't even put up a fight. In the past she would fight it, adding more fuel to the fire. But now she figured it was going to happen no matter what she did. It was inevitable.

Once in the chamber Shadow Weaver threw her to the ground. Catra stood there as Shadow Weaver walked over to the Black

Garnet to recharge her powers.

"You think you can do whatever you want whenever you want. You've been nothing but a nuisance to me from the first day we brought you into the Horde. You don't follow orders, and you can't manage to get along with any of the other cadets. And let's not forget how you're constantly distracting Adora." Shadow Weaver said as she approached Catra.

"And that little show you put on earlier with Adora. Holding her hand in front of the other cadets and force captains knowing that that kind of behavior isn't allowed in the Horde." She said as she approached her. Red static seeped from her hands as she got closer.

"Adora grabbed my hand, I didn't grab hers. And the other cadets treat me like a freak, so why should I try and get along with them?" She said as she positioned herself on her hands and knees. She knew it was coming, so she tried to position herself in a way where the electricity wouldn't hurt as much. If she was being completely honest, no matter what position she was in, it always hurt.

Shadow Weaver forced her into a standing position. Her body was encased with the red electricity seeping from Shadow Weaver's hands. Shadow Weaver forced her to look her in her eyes. Catra felt strong stinging throughout her body. She watched as dark shadows surrounded them.

"Do not lie to me. We both know it is you who is confusing Adora. The only reason you are still here is because she is so fond of you. Which I will never understand because you are nothing but distraction." She said as she held Catra with her electricity. With each word she spat at her the electricity that wrapped around Catra's body became more intensified.

Catra tried to stop herself from screaming, but the electricity that was coursing through her was to much. Tears fell from her eyes from how much pain she was in. She couldn't help it, she let out a

blood curtailing yell. This made Shadow Weaver even more angry. The thought of someone catching her "disciplining" Catra made her uneasy, and with the unease came the unknowing. The unknowing made her shaky. She didn't know what would happen if she was caught, and that made her angry. The angrier she got the more the electricity intensified. Eventually Catra passed out from the intensity of the electricity. Shadow Weaver just walked away, leaving the unconscious child laying on the floor.

Catra didn't know how long she was unconscious, but she did know she missed dinner again. She struggled to get to her feet. She wobbled out of the chamber and headed straight for the Barracks. She knew the cadets had to have been asleep by then. She reached the quarters and made her way to Adora's bunk.To her surprise the girl was awake, staring at her as she made her way to her. Adora lifted her arm and Catra crawled into them. As she laid there she let tears fall down her face. She stared at Adora as she drifted off the sleep.

Chapter End Notes

> Hey I hope you enjoyed. I hope this chapter wasn't too much for you. We all know Shadow Weaver is a bitch, and we all know she's very manipulative. And although it isn't really discussed we know that she was abusive to Catra. Anyways like I warned you in the end of the last chapter. I will also warn you here and in the beginning of the next chapter, it is also dark. Details to follow in the beginning of the next chapter.
>
> ~The Guardian 👽

Chapter 6: Pressure

Chapter Summary

> With all the exceptions and pressure Shadow Weaver puts on Adora to be the best of the best, naturally there's bound to be some stress and anxiety.

Chapter Notes

> As I've mentioned before I will be warning you guys if there are some dark themes. Welcome to chapter 6 which is really chapter 5.
>
> TRIGGERED WARNING: SELF HARM
>
> There is self harm mentioned, I don't think it's that bad tbh but a warning just to be safe. And as usual Shadow Weaver being a piece of shit mother

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Pressure

Adora never questioned the relationship between Catra and Shadow Weaver. Adora knew Shadow Weaver was hard on Catra and way easier on her. Catra and the other cadets thought Adora got special treatment, which if she thought about it she kind of did. But what Catra and the other cadets didn't know was the amount of pressure Shadow Weaver put on Adora on a daily basis. She had no other purpose than to train to became a force captain. It was like she was a machine. It was the only thing Adora knew from the day she could walk.

When Catra beat Adora in training, she was forced to train while the other cadets were asleep. Adora trained day and night just to

please Shadow Weaver. The pressure she was under sometimes was unbearable, but Adora put on a brave face. She made sure no one ever knew how much pressure she was under. She made sure no one knew how tired she truly was. She made sure no one knew how bad her anxiety was. Even when it was just her and Catra, she never let Catra see how truly tired and stressed out she was.

But sometimes Adora couldn't hide her anxiety. She couldn't keep a brave face. Training after training, day after day. Shadow Weaver pushed and pushed and sometimes Adora couldn't take it. The only way Adora knew how to get the anxiety out was with violence. Most of the time Adora would punch random things just to help herself breathe. She never physically harmed any of the other cadets when she was having an episode. Most of the harm was to herself. Maybe it was to make her feel like she was in control of the pain she was feeling. Or maybe that was the only way for her to relieve the stress. One thing Adora did know is that when one of these episodes did occurred, the only time she stopped was when she saw blood.

The first time Adora ever had a sever episode was when she was 12. Hand to hand combat training was just about finished. Adora had just finished sparring against another cadet, and she didn't really do to well. In a matter of minutes Adora was on the ground with a staff in her face. Adora was so upset with her loss, but she knew Shadow Weaver would be even more disappointed. They had an extra training lesson the night before, and Shadow Weaver expected her to be ready for whatever was coming her way. But in all reality Adora didn't really sleep that well after the training session. While she laid on her bunk, Catra in her arms of course, in the Barracks her mind raced.

She thought about all the moves they had practiced. She thought about how she going to take down her opponent. She thought about the many ways she would succeed. But mostly she thought about Shadow Weaver and how she couldn't disappoint her. How she had to win or Shadow Weaver would think that Adora wasn't taking training seriously. Or that she wasn't trying hard enough to

became a force captain. But this sparring match proved just that, that she had disappointed her.

"Sloppy work today, Adora." Shadow Weaver said, as the other cadets left the training room. Adora couldn't even look her in the eyes, so she stared at the ground.

"Look at me when I speak to you." She said with irritation in her voice. Usually that irritation was reserved for Catra, but clearly she was disappointed in her performance that day.

Adora obeyed the command and looked Shadow Weaver in the eyes. She could see her eyes were narrowed but then soften when Adora made eye contact with her.

"Adora, what happened today? Did we not train hard enough for you to beat your opponent? Maybe we should double up on the training." Shadow Weaver said in a less irritated voice.

"No!" Adora said quickly. "It's just, I couldn't sleep. So I was tired and wasn't focused."

"And why are you tired? I already know why. It's Catra. I told you to distance yourself from her. I've told you several times not to let her distract you, and now look at what she's done, you're doing poorly in your training. She's making me look like a fool." Shadow Weaver said, with her eyes narrowing again.

"No, it wasn't Catra's fault, It was mine. I'm the reason why I'm tired. I had to much energy from training last night so I couldn't sleep." She said, looking back at the ground. She wasn't completely lying she did have a lot of energy after training.

"Mmm. I still think that she distracts you when it comes to becoming force captain." Shadow Weaver said, with less hate in her eyes.

"Nonetheless, straight back here after dinner. You'll train until it's time for lights out. You may go get cleaned up and ready for

dinner." Shadow Weaver said, as she walked out of the training room, leaving Adora alone with her rushing thoughts.

Adora exited the training room a few minutes later with to many thoughts flooding her mind. She reached the locker room and checked through the shower stalls, to make sure she was alone. Lucky for her she was. She got undress and head to a shower stall all the way in the back. She let the water warm up before she got in.

As soon as she got in, she let the hot water hit her sore and tired body as she thought about what a failure she was. How could she have lost? She trained so hard last night. How could she be such a failure? How could she let her thoughts keep her up all night? How could she have disappointed Shadow Weaver after all the work they put in last night. Did she really waste Shadow Weaver's time? Did she really train last night to just fail at something that she's been doing her whole life?

As each thought flooded her mind, she punched the brick wall in front of her. Each punch harder as her thoughts intensified. Thought after thought, punch after punch. Harder and harder. Over and over again. After about 2 minutes her knuckles started to bleed. She finally looked down at her hand and noticed the blood. She placed her knuckles under the hot water and massaged them. She knew if Shadow Weaver saw her knuckles she would be highly upset, just another reason for Shadow Weaver to think she's a failure.

A few minutes later she got dressed and headed to the dinning hall for whatever time was left for dinner. She found Catra sitting at a table with some other cadets. She walked over and sat right next to her. Catra looked at her and then looked at her extremely purple hand.

"What happened to your hand?" Catra said, pulling Adora out of her trans.

"What?"

"What happened to your hand?"

"Oh, uh training." She said, looking down at her hand.

The dinner bell rang, informing the cadets that dinner was over. While everyone else found themselves relaxing in the Barracks, Adora found herself in the training room once again. Shadow Weaver stood inside, her eyes drifting to her swollen and possibly broken hand. Her eyes narrowed.

"Do not think that that hand is going to prevent you from training. Force captains don't let things like swollen hands stop them. They work through the pain, no matter how bad." Shadow Weaver said as she looked at Adora.

"Now, let's begin."

Chapter End Notes

> I hope you enjoyed this chapter. Sorry that it's two days late. I just wanted to give you guys some time. One more dark chapter after this one. Then there's a cute chapter.
>
> ~The Guardian 👽

Chapter 7: Thoughts

Chapter Summary

> With Shadow Weaver constantly reminding Catra that she would never amount to anything in life, she is bound to have anxiety. And growing up in the Horde means no showing weakness

Chapter Notes

> Hello, it has been a while. As usual whenever something is triggering I warn you in the beginning and I warned you in the notes at the end of the previous chapter. I'm not going to warn about Shadow Weaver's manipulation because that's a reoccurring theme in the story
>
> TW: SELF HARM
>
> Anyways I hope you enjoy.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Thoughts

Catra always knew when Adora had episodes. Adora wasn't really good at hiding the stress she was enduring, no matter how many lies she told Catra. But unlike Adora, Catra was a way better liar than she was. She was able to lie about Shadow Weaver's "disciplinary" treatment, so naturally her being able to lie about her own way of dealing with stress was just as easy.

Sure she would never be able to understand all the pressure Shadow Weaver put on Adora, but she did understand trying to please the elder women. The difference was that Adora was praised for her accomplishments while Catra wasn't. Catra trained

hard, harder than anyone else. She used her cat like abilities to her advantage, but it was never enough for Shadow Weaver.

Shadow Weaver despised when Catra used her abilities to get ahead. She clearly had a better advantage against the other cadets. But even when she didn't use her "abilities" Shadow Weaver still had a problem with Catra coming in first. Especially when it came to Adora.

The difference between Adora and Catra's episodes is that Adora's episodes were triggered by pressure while Catra's were triggered by not being able to be accepted by anyone besides Adora. When Catra had an episode it always ended in blood, but sometimes blood didn't stop her from causing serious damage to herself or others.

With all the wins Catra took during training, nothing would be better than a "Great work Catra" From Shadow Weaver. But she never heard those words from her, no matter how many times she won or came out with the new time.

The first time Shadow Weaver's hate for her triggered an episode was when she was about 12. They were wrapping up a sparring match. It was Catra vs Adora and Catra won. The fight was quite entertaining, with Adora pinning Catra a couple of times which caused a tie. But the final match was what made the sparring more intense. Although Adora put up a great fight eventually she lost to how quickly Catra moved. Shadow Weaver's eyes narrowed as the match ended.

"Adora, sloppy, sloppy work. You let her slip right through your fingers. How do you expect to become a force captain if you can't even stop yourself from getting distracted? You have to pay attention. You must be focused. Next time I want you to win. No messing around. If you aren't serious when training then I am wasting my time. Am I wasting my time Adora?"

"No, I was taking the match seriously. But Catra is my friend, I don't want to hurt her. We take turns on the matches. Some

matches I win and the other matches she wins. That way the fights are fair. That's how it was during the beginning of the match, but then I noticed Catra was actually fighting."

"Do you think other force captains loose fights during a battle just because they are friends? Do you think they take turns losing and winning fights? No because they take being a force captain serious. Now go and get showered and ready for lights out." She said, dismissing Adora.

Catra approached Shadow with no hesitation. She was to busy getting compliments and praise from the other cadets that she didn't realize that Shadow Weaver had just reprimanded Adora. Catra felt like she was on the top of the world. As she approached, Shadow Weaver's eyes narrowed.

"So how did I do?" Catra said with a little too much excitement in her voice. Shadow Weaver stared at the girl, with eyes narrowed into even thinner slits.

"You just got lucky today. Adora was going easy on you. She felt like she owed it you, to let you win, because of your friendship. But next match she will not be holding back. She must be ready to become a force captain, and she can't have any distractions, and you seem to be the biggest one. Plaguing her thoughts. Making her feel like her friendship with you is more important than her destiny to became a force captain. I will not let you jeopardize her future for some silly friendship. I advise you to distance yourself from her and stop distracting her. She has a bright future ahead of her and all you're doing is dragging her down. Now go get ready for lights out." Shadow Weaver said, eyes still in a thin slit.

Catra stared at the women in front of her, tears in her eyes. It wasn't like Catra hadn't heard all of this before. It's all she's ever heard from the woman standing before her. How she's a distraction to Adora. How Adora doesn't really want to be her friend. How Adora is destined for greatness while she wasn't. How Adora is wasting her time being her friend. How everything she

does will never mean anything. How she's just something to occupy Adora when she's bored.

Catra had heard it all before. The difference this time is that during this match she put her all into it. Sure her and Adora would alternate who won what match, but this time it was different. She trained extra hard the days before. Sometimes she'd stay up when it was lights out just to train. She wanted to beat Adora. Truly beat her with everything she had. Adora had caught on after the first round and actually started fighting for real. It was an exciting fight where they both put in their all, and Catra actually won.

"Why are you still standing in front of me? I have already spoken and dismissed you. Go get ready for lights out." Shadow Weaver said with anger in her tone.

"She didn't let me win, I beat her. She lost." Catra said, as tears rolled down her face. Shadow weaver stared at her.

"This is the last time I am going to address you. I do not care for your thoughts on the match or those tears rolling down your face. Like I said before you distracted Adora and that's the only reason you won. I do not want to discuss this any further. NOW GO GET READY FOR LIGHTS OUT BEFORE YOU FORCE MY HAND." Shadow Weaver said, as shadows started to creep up around them.

Catra backed out of the training room and ran to the locker room. Naturally by the time she entered everyone had finished showering and were probably already in the Barracks getting ready for lights out. She was all alone. With everything Shadow Weaver had just said racing through her head.

Maybe Shadow Weaver was right. Maybe Adora didn't really want to be her friend. Maybe Catra was nothing but a distraction. Maybe Adora only hung out with her because she was bored. Maybe Catra wasn't good enough to call Adora a friend, let alone have Adora call her a friend. The more she thought the angrier she got.

She beat Adora. She did. Shadow Weaver had to see that she put in so much time and effort into beating her. She actually succeeded. Why couldn't Shadow Weaver just be proud of her. Was it so hard for her to just give her a thumbs up for her efforts? Maybe it was her. Maybe she wasn't worthy enough for a thumbs up. Maybe she could never please Shadow Weaver. Maybe no matter how hard she tried nothing she ever did would be good enough.

She enter the shower. The water boiling hot as it hit her skin. Her claws began to extend as her thoughts started to consume her. The thoughts were suffocating her. Blinding her. She started to dig her claws into her outer thigh not even noticing. Blood started to drip down her leg. She dug deeper and motioned her hand up as if she were scratching her thigh, causing more blood to pour out. She was brought out of her deep thoughts when she finally registered the pain. She looked down and finally noticed how deep and long the wound was.

She let the hot water hit her leg as she tried to clean the blood. She didn't really feel the pain until she looked down and saw it. Naturally when someone hurts themselves they freak out, but it felt like a relief for her. It was something she could control. She could control the amount of pain she felt. It was a great way for her to relieve stress. A great way for her not worry about what Shadow Weaver thought of her. The words Shadow Weaver used to bring her down. The thoughts of Adora not wanting to be her friend. She knew the last one was a lie. She knew Adora would always want to be her friend. But Shadow Weaver had a way of making her believe whatever she said.

She exited the shower and cleaned up the wound. She found some gauze and tape in her locker. With such sharp nails she would accidentally cut herself occasionally, especially when training. She placed the gauze on her wound and used the tape to keep it in place. She got dressed and headed towards the Barracks.

When she entered the Barracks she saw Adora sitting up on her bunk. She was waiting for her.

"You're here. I was waiting for you. I wanted to make sure you we're ok. You did a great job today." Adora said as Catra approached her.

"Oh, uh thanks" she said, trying to hide her blushing.

"And I'm fine. Shadow Weaver was just, telling me how I can do better next time we have a match." She lied, as she rubbed the area where she placed the gauze.

"Oh ok. You can come lay down with me. I kept the bed warm." She said as she patted on the bed.

"That's alright I think I'll sleep down here. It gives you more space to stretch out. I know your muscles hurt from our match." Catra said, as she laid at the bottom of the bunk, where Adora's feet barely reached her.

Catra couldn't risk Adora feeling the gauze on her thigh. She knew Adora would question her about it. She knew she couldn't say it was from the match because Adora didn't have sharp nails. And if Adora found out the truth then she would tell Shadow Weaver. And of course Shadow Weaver would be very upset and would want to cut her claws. Catra couldn't bare the thought of not having her claws. They were a part of her and Shadow Weaver couldn't, wouldn't take that away from her.

"Ok but if you change your mind your side will still be here. Goodnight." She said as she laid down

"Goodnight"

Chapter End Notes

> Hi, I forgot to say happy New Year's. I hope this year brings you nothing but happiness and joy. Anyways I hope you enjoyed. Sorry I've been gone so long. I've decided to turn

this into a series, where I have backgrounds for other couples. Mainly underrated couples because whenever you see a She Ra fanfic Catradora is the main couple. Not just couples but characters too. There will be more than one chapter as well. Enough of that, as promised the next chapter is cute. Anyways thanks for reading and don't forget to tell a friend

~The Guardian 👽

Chapter 8: Feelings

Chapter Summary

> Adora starts to explore her feelings for Catra. She wants Catra to know exactly how she feels and the only way she knows how is through a kiss.

Chapter Notes

> Hi, here's some fluff because I feel like I've been torturing you guys with a lot of hurt/comfort and hella angst. No trigger warning. Shadow Weaver is still a bitch so don't be surprised.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Feelings

No matter how hard Adora tried she could never stay away from Catra. No matter how many times Shadow Weaver tried to keep them apart. No matter how many times she told her she was a distraction or how many times she told her that Catra wasn't good enough to be around her. But Adora didn't care, she loved Catra's company. She loved everything about Catra. Even the things Catra hated about herself.

She loved how confident she was. She loved that no matter how negative Shadow Weaver was towards her, she still tried to get some sort of praise from the elder women. Catra made Adora feel like her life wasn't just about becoming force captain.

Growing up in the Horde there were rules that needed to be followed. Rules that were specifically enforced for cadets Shadow Weaver saw potential in. Also specific rules for cadets who she had to keep a close eye on. If any rules were broken there were always serious consequences.

Adora always knew this but she couldn't help herself. As they grew up in the Horde, there were things happening behind Shadow Weaver's back. Things that broke specific rules Shadow Weaver had enforced.

One of Shadow Weaver's specific rules she had for Adora was to limit unnecessary physical contact, especially with Catra. Something about Shadow Weaver wanting Adora to limit physical contact with Catra made her want to be closer to her. Spend more time with her. Be near her as much as she could. Catra never seemed to be bothered by it either. In fact Catra craved as much of the attention as Adora did. With new feelings developing they were finding it harder and harder to stay away from each other.

But with Shadow Weaver constantly watching Adora and Catra like a hawk, there was rarely any time for it. Shadow Weaver was always focused on what Catra and Adora were doing. She never allowed Catra and Adora to be alone in a room for more than an hour, with the exception of lights out and when they showered. But nothing ever got past Shadow Weaver without her knowing.

One night after training, when they were about 13, Adora and Catra were getting ready for lights out. Training had gone well and Shadow Weaver didn't seem as disappointed as she usually was. Adora felt like she could do anything. She was so happy and excited. She didn't have night training which was awesome. After a few minutes the other cadets left the locker room leaving Catra and Adora alone.

"You did a great job today!" Adora said as she put her tank top on.

"Yea, you did too. And did you see Shadow Weaver, she didn't seem as disappointed as she usually is." Catra chuckled as she leaned against a locker, watching Adora put on her shorts.

"I know. On a plus side, since training went so well I don't have to have a night training session with her." Adora said sitting in front of Catra

"Well that's good. They seem like they really stress you out. And you're always so fidgety when you climb into our bunk." Catra said looking down at Adora.

"Our bunk? I think you mean my bunk. " Adora said as she got up from the bench to stand in front of Catra.

"Oh please, you and I both know that you can't sleep without me laying next to you. or at least near you." Catra said with a sly smirk on her face.

"Ok but you can't stand there and tell me you don't enjoy laying next me. Especially when I rub behind your ears and pet the top of your head. Oh and the cute purrs you let out when you relax into my arms." Adora said as she leaned her back against the locker next to Catra.

Catra started blushing, looking everywhere but at Adora. Adora moved closer to Catra. Close enough that their shoulders touched. Adora turned her head to look at Catra, who was still avoiding eye contact by staring straight ahead.

"I guess this means I won this little argument huh?" Adora said moving closer to Catra, who was still avoiding eye contact.

"I wasn't aware that this was an argument. I though I was just telling you how weird you get after night training sessions." Catra said turning her whole body to face Adora.

Adora stared at Catra. More importantly she stared at her lips. Adora had seen other cadets kiss each other, but she's never personally done it herself. She felt like she needed to share her first kiss experience with some she had a deep connection with. She figured who better than the person she cares so deeply about. The person she needed to be around all the time. The person she had deep and strong feelings for.

Adora knew if Shadow Weaver ever found out they would be in trouble, but she couldn't help herself. The urge to feel Catra's lips on her own was unbearable as she inched closer to Catra's face.

To her surprise Catra was also moving closer. Soon their foreheads were touching. They stood like that for a couple of seconds before Adora tilted her head and their lips made contact.

Adora felt her body melt as she kissed Catra. She lifted one hand to hold Catra, as the other hand cupped Catra's face. Adora felt like she was going to explode. She felt butterflies in her stomach. She felt her heart beat start to increase. She felt like her knees were turning into jelly.

The kiss was over before Adora wanted it to be. Catra pulled away with her face as red as a tomatoe. She couldn't make eye contact with Adora, so she turned, leaning against the lockers again, staring straight ahead. Adora felt like her cheeks were on fire. She looked down at the ground.

"I, uh. I'm sorry if I crossed a line. Urg I shouldn't have done that, if Shadow Weaver finds out we're dead. I-I just couldn't help myself. I don't know what came over me." Adora said, as she sat back on the bench in front of Catra. Hands covering her face as she avoided looking in Catra's direction.

After a few minutes Catra removed Adora's hands from her face and held them in her own. Catra looked directly at her.

"It's alright Adora. Honestly if you didn't do it I probably would've. You just had the courage to do it before me." Catra said with a look of admiration, as Adora finally made eye contact with her.

"Really?" Adora said, with a raised eyebrow and a smirk on her face.

"Adora, don't read to much into it ok." Catra said already regretting telling her that piece of information.

"So you wanted to kiss me, huh? For how long?" Adora asked, as Catra released her hands.

"Adora, let it go" Catra said, getting slightly irritated.

"Alright, alright." Adora said as Catra turned towards the locker room exit.

"But how was it?"

"What?!"

"How was the kiss? Like on a scale of 1-10. 10 being the best thing you've ever experienced in your life, 5 being it was alright, and 1 being it needs work."

"Adora." Catra said as they walked towards the exit of the locker room.

"Come on, how am I supposed to know if I'm good at it if the one person I kissed won't even tell me if it was good or not." Adora said in a whiney voice.

Catra stopped in front of the locker room exit and let out a sharp exhale.

"Fine, it was a 5. But you could use some more practice." Catra said blushing

"Are you saying you'll help me practice?" Adora asked with that stupid raised eyebrow and even stupider grin.

Catra turned and opened the door only to have Shadow Weaver standing in front of her. Her eyes narrowed as she saw Adora approach from behind.

"And why are you two still in the locker room? Lights out was 8 minutes ago, yet you two are still in here while everyone else is already in the Barracks." Shadow Weaver said as she looked back at Catra with narrower eyes.

"It was my fault. By the time I got to take a shower the water was cold so I decided to wait for it to get hot. And I asked Catra to wait for me so I didn't have to walk to the Barracks alone." Adora said as they exited the locker room.

"Do not make this a habit. When it is time for lights out I expect you BOTH to be in the Barracks. Whether you have taken a shower or not. Do I make myself clear? " Shadow Weaver asked as she looked down at both girls.

"Yes Shadow Weaver." They said in unison.

"Now get to the Barracks. And I'll see you two an hour before breakfast for an early morning training. You can't break the rules and not expect there to be consequences." Shadow Weaver said, as the two girls turned the corner.

"Woo, that was close." Adora said with a laugh of relief.

"Now back to my previous question, are you saying you're going to help me practice?" Adora said as they reached the entrance to the Barracks.

Catra rolled her eyes and entered.

"So is that a yes?" Adora asked following after her.

Chapter End Notes

> I hope you enjoyed this cute chapter because after this one we go back to our regularly scheduled programming and my favorite thing to write about, angst. The next chapter is pretty dark and it's the longest chapter I wrote so far. It actually took me about 2 and half weeks to write it. They say write what you know but I honest don't know shit about most of the stuff I write about for this fanfic so there's always a challenge. Anyways enough of my rambling, I hope you enjoyed and don't forget to tell a friend and tell that friend to tell another friend.
>
> ~The Guardian 👽

Chapter 9: Caught

Chapter Summary

> Catra felt like she was in Heaven. For 3 days straight she was able to feel connected to Adora in a way that was just meant for them. Nothing or nobody could bring her down. Or maybe one person could.

Chapter Notes

> Hi I've been gone for a while because I wanted you guys to mentally prepare yourselves for this chapter. I think it's dark but that's just me. I think this is the longest chapter I've written so far. There are triggers so.
>
> TW: CHILD ABUSE, MIND MANIPULATION

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Caught

Catra definitely helped Adora practice kissing. They practiced every chance they got. With every kiss they shared Catra craved Adora's closeness. Of course their kisses were limited to the locker room and sometimes, with caution of course, the Barracks. Which meant they only took place after training and occasionally during lights out.

Catra's need to be close to Adora, to feel her lips on her own every chance she got made things more risky. Of course Adora didn't object. She enjoyed the attention and closeness. She also craved it, she needed it as much as Catra did. So for the two days after their first kiss they were as close as they could be to each other. Catra couldn't keep herself from watching Adora as they trained. She couldn't help the smile that formed on her face when she was near Adora.

Of course for Catra all good things always came to an end. Shadow Weaver watched every single move Catra made when it came to Adora. She noticed how inseparable they became after that night she caught them outside of the Barracks past lights out. Shadow Weaver noticed how Adora would go easy on Catra when it came to training. Making Shadow Weaver look like a fool. Like her efforts to train Adora into a force captain were a waste of her time. Catra was clearly distracting her.

Catra was on cloud nine. Nothing could bring her down. Not even Shadow Weaver's remarks on how poorly she was doing in training. All she could think about was Adora. Shadow Weaver could see the happiness and wanted to destroy it, needed to destroy it. Catra being happy clearly had something to do with Adora being distracted. Not trying hard enough. Making her feel like her efforts were a waste. She needed to figure out what was going.

On the third day after training Catra and Adora went to the locker room, took a shower and waited for everyone to file out. At first they were hesitant but eventually Catra took the lead and kissed Adora. The kiss lasted a few minutes and then Adora pulled away.

"Wow I think we've made a lot of progress in the last three days. of course my kissing is way better than yours but you know." Adora said, as she headed towards her locker.

"Does everything have to be a competition with you? Besides, we both know I'm the better kisser." Catra said, as she watched Adora walk towards her locker.

"Well making it a competition has clearly improved my kissing skills. I wish I could say the same for you." Adora said with that stupid grin on her face

"Whatever. Let's get out of here before Shadow Weaver finds out we aren't in the barracks." Catra said as she shoved Adora towards the exit.

Adora headed towards the exit and Catra followed close behind. Catra watched as Adora peeked her head into the hallway of the Frightzone. Adora gave a thumbs up and they exited the locker room. They walked down the hall with caution. As they reached the end of the hallway, they relaxed a little only to tense up once again as they turned the corner.

To their surprise Shadow Weaver was standing in front of the door to the Barracks with her arms folded and eyes so thin you could barley see the white. The two of them stood at the corner. Neither of them dared to approach the women. Catra didn't know what to say. Her throat was dry and she felt her legs shaking. Then Adora stepped forward, standing in front of Catra.

"Shadow Weaver, I can explain. We were just-"

"You two seem to think that the rules do not apply to you. This is the 3rd time this week you have been late for lights out." Shadow Weaver said, interrupting Adora.

"I do not want your excuses. I've told you countless times before Adora, you do not need any distractions. You must stay focused on training so you can become the best force captain, and yet you still find ways to disobey me. And with the biggest distraction of them all none the less." Shadow Weaver stared daggers at Catra as she finished her sentence. She held Catra in place with just that look. Catra didn't look away either. She couldn't, not with the fear of Shadow Weaver "disciplining" her again. Shadow Weaver turned her attention back to Adora.

"What has been so important that you feel the need to disobey a given rule? Everyone else doesn't seem to have a problem with the rules that are enforced. But you two seem to not be able to follow them. And obviously morning training session aren't helping you grasp that following rules in the Horde is a must. So tell me what was so important that you decided to disobey me." Shadow Weaver said, as she approached them.

Neither of them said anything. Catra felt herself shrinking as she came closer. She could see shadows start to approach them as Shadow Weaver got closer. The slits of her eyes were more narrow than Catra had ever seen before.

Then she reached where they were standing. Hovering over the two girls. Catra felt sweat dripping down her back. She couldn't turn her head to look at Adora but she knew she was just as scared. The shadows around them dimming down the lights that surrounded them, making it hard to see the woman hovering over them.

And then ever so suddenly Shadow Weaver's eyes were back to their regular size. The shadows had disappeared. Shadow Weaver just stood in front of them, staring at both of them. Catra still felt very uncomfortable. There was no way that it was over just like that. She didn't even get an answer. There was no way Shadow Weaver was just going to let this go. Especially because Catra was involved. There was no way. Someone was going to have to pay the price. Catra doubted that it was going to be Adora, so that only left one option, her.

"Both of you, follow me." Shadow Weaver said turning around so suddenly.

Adora didn't hesitate. She started walking as soon as Shadow Weaver turned around and took a step forward. Catra hesitated but eventually followed. She trailed behind Adora, her heart beating so hard she could swear that Adora could hear it. Catra knew where Shadow Weaver was taking them and she could barley breath. The air around her felt like it was thinning.

They reached the Black Garnet chamber and Shadow Weaver walked in first followed by Adora. Catra stood in the threshold for a couple of seconds but reluctantly went inside. The sound of the door swooshing shut made her jump.

Shadow Weaver approached the Black Garnet, absorbing as much power as she could from it. Catra stood next to Adora in a corner

as Adora watched in anticipation. They didn't know what was going to happen. The only other time Catra and Adora were both in the Black Garnet chamber together was when they were younger, and that encounter didn't end very well. Especially for Catra.

"Now, tell me what was so important that you have been late for lights out 3 nights in a row." Shadow Weaver said, as she approached the two girls in the corner. There was red electricity seeping from her hands and the shadows started to creep up behind her as she approached. Catra could feel the red electricity encase her body as Shadow Weaver raised a hand. She was lifted off the floor as the red electricity started to get more intense.

"You can make this stop if you just tell me." Shadow Weaver said as she looked at Adora, fear in her eyes. Catra knew Shadow Weaver would never try to hurt Adora, at least not the way she would hurt her.

"TELL ME." Shadow Weaver yelled, as the electricity intensified causing Catra to yell out of pain.

"Ok, ok, just stop hurting her. It wasn't her idea, it was mine. I'm the one who started the whole thing." Adora said, as she stepped forward with fear in her eyes.

"Please Shadow Weaver, just let her go. I'll tell you everything. Just please let her go." Shadow Weaver stared at Adora and slowly lowered Catra back down to the floor. The red electricity slowly dissolving from around her.

Catra laid on the floor unable to move. The pain from the electricity momentarily paralyzing her and making it hard for her to catch her breathe. All she could do was watch Adora as she approached her. She sat next to her and wrapped her arms around her.

Shadow Weaver watched in disgusted. The shadows still around the Black Garnet chamber.

"Oh Adora. " Shadow Weaver said, as she watched her pathetic attempts to console Catra. Catra was shaking as she encased her in her arms and rubbed her back.

"All you have to do is tell me why you disobeyed the rules and all of her pain will be over." Shadow Weaver said, as she moved closer to them.

Adora looked up at Shadow Weaver with anger in her eyes. Catra had never seen Adora that angry.

"She was helping me." Adora said, as Catra shook her head no at her.

"Helping you with what?" Shadow Weaver said as she moved even more closer to them. The shadows around them dimming the lights again, as they grew bigger.

"She was helping me learn how to kiss." Adora said, as her and Catra stood up.

Shadow Weaver grabbed Adora and dragged her away from Catra. Catra watched in horror not knowing what to expect. Catra had never seen Shadow Weaver get this angry, especially not with Adora.

"I knew this would happen." Shadow Weaver said, still dragging Adora away from Catra

"I should have stopped it before it got out of hand. I knew she would distract you. Making you think that this was your idea. Making you do inappropriate things. Forcing you to do inappropriate things. Making you think that your relationship with her is more important than becoming a force captain. Making me look like a fool. All the effort and time I put into molding you. Into shaping you into the best force captain in all of the Horde. All my hard work being wasted just because you feel like you need her as a friend." Shadow Weaver said, as red electricity started seeping out of her hands once again.

She continued rambling on and on as she dragged Adora to a table. Adora tried to break out of Shadow Weaver's grasp but she encased her in the same red electricity she had Catra in a couple of minutes ago. Catra started to approach them slowly still clearly in pain.

"Just because you feel things for her and you feel the need to act on those feelings. Proper cadets don't let their emotions and feelings get in the way of their training. They especially don't act on said feelings. But you both knew that, didn't you? That's why you did it in secrecy. Hoping I'd never find out. But you both weren't as sneaky as you thought you were. I saw the way you looked at each other. The way Catra would stare at you during training, or the way your body language changed when she was around you. She made you weak. Unfocused. But I have a solution for that." Shadow Weaver said as she strapped Adora into a table and hovered over her.

"When I'm done with you, you will not remember this little setback you had with Catra." She said as she looked back at Catra, who was now a few feet away, still shaking.

"What are you going to do to her?" Catra said, holding her arm in her free hand.

"I am going to make sure she doesn't remember this little incident between the two of you. I'm going to make sure she doesn't remember who you are. That way you can't distract her with your wants and needs." Shadow Weaver said, as placed her fingertips on Adora's temples.

Red electricity started to seep from her hands again. Adora started to shake trying to stop Shadow Weaver. But the more she moved the angrier Shadow Weaver got.

Catra heard Adora grunting. She couldn't look at her. The thought of Shadow Weaver making Adora forget all about her made her feel like she was dying. She couldn't live with adora not knowing who she was. Adora was literally her only friend. The only one

who made feel like she was important. Made her feel like she wasn't just another stupid cadet. She made her feel special. She couldn't loose that. She needed it. She needed her to know who she was.

"Wait please." Catra said, as she looked on in horror.

"I'll leave her alone, I promise. Just don't make her forget who I am. Please." Catra begged her.

"Catra no. I don't want you to leave me alone." Adora yelled as she stared at Catra with tears in her eyes.

"It's the only way Adora. That way I won't be completely out of your life." Catra said looking at Adora as tears also formed in her eyes.

"Fine, but I'm still going to make her forget about this incident." Shadow Weaver said, as she placed her fingertips back on Adora's temples.

Catra watched as Adora tried to wiggle away from Shadow Weaver with no luck. Adora let out a scream that made Catra cringe. The only thing Catra had to distract her was the memory of the way Adora's lips felt on hers. The feeling she got when their lips touched. The warmth she felt. The way her stomach filled with butterflies as Adora's hands lingered on the side of her face. She would never forget those feelings. She would cherish them for the rest of her life.

Suddenly Adora stopped screaming, and Catra was brought out of her memories. Adora was passed out as Shadow Weaver stepped away. Catra approached Adora and placed her hand on her cheek. Shadow Weaver watched, clearly drained from the overuse of her powers.

"See what happens when you distract her from her destiny? When you put your own selfish wants and needs before her training? For the future I hope you keep your promise. We wouldn't want her to

forget about you entirely now would we?" Catra didn't respond. She just stared at Adora and she rubbed her cheek

"Now take her back to the Barracks. And make sure you do not wake anyone. Straight to the Barracks and to sleep." She said, turning her back to face the Black Garnet. Catra unlocked Adora from the table and helped her stand. Adora was slightly conscious, but she struggled to stand on her own. Catra helped her by letting her lean on her as they walked out of the chamber. Shadow Weaver didn't look back once.

The walk to the Barracks was quiet and eerie. Adora held onto Catra like she was the only thing that could keep her grounded. Catra didn't speak she just looked straight ahead as they made their way to the Barracks.

They entered the Barracks and Catra helped Adora into her bunk. Catra laid Adora down and then crawled in next to her. Catra placed her arm on top of Adora's stomach and watched her breathing. She placed a kiss on Adora's cheek, with tears in her eyes, as Adora drifted off to sleep. She stood awake for the rest of the night making sure Adora was still breathing.

Chapter End Notes

> Hi. I'm sorry. I feel like I owe you guys an apology for having you go through that. I would say the next chapter is better but I'd be lying. It isn't as bad as this chapter is, so there's that. Anyway, as always if you want to complain or voice your opinion on this chapter you can find me @catrasboobwindow on Instagram. I hope you enjoyed? Or didn't enjoy? This chapter isn't supposed to bring anyone joy. See you next chapter
>
> ~The Guardian 👽

Chapter 10: Aftermath (Adora)

Chapter Summary

> The aftermath on Adora after Shadow Weaver's mind manipulation

Chapter Notes

> Hello, I haven't really been gone that long at least that's what I think, anyway this chapter has been done for a while now but I wanted to give y'all some time to process and heal from the last chapter

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Aftermath (Adora)

Adora woke up the next morning to an empty bed and a huge pounding in her head. Her body felt weak. She couldn't remember what had happened last night. All she could remember was training and then heading to the locker room to get ready for lights out. In fact she could only remember bits and pieces of the previous 3 days.

She sat up slowly wincing every time she overexerted her body. The pounding in her increased as soon as she was able to sit up, immediately forcing her to lay back down. She scanned around the Barracks in search of Catra, but she was no where to be found. She did notice that she was the only cadet still in there.

Adora started to panic. What would Shadow Weaver think if Adora was late for breakfast? How could she had overslept? How could she had been so careless? Shadow Weaver would definitely notice her being late for breakfast. Shadow Weaver noticed everything she did. There was no way she was going to get away with this. Shadow Weaver wouldn't want to hear her excuses. She expected

Adora to take responsibility for her actions. How could she become a great force captain with excuses?

Adora rushed to her feet, head pound with every movement she made. The headache was the least of her problems though. She put on her uniform and rushed out of the Barracks. The bright lights in the hall only intensifying the pain in her head. The hallway lights forcing her to stare at the floor as she made her way to the dinning hall.

To her surprise the cadets were still eating breakfast by the time she entered the dinning hall. She looked around for Catra, but didn't find her. Where could she have been? She knew missing breakfast would have her in big trouble with Shadow Weaver. She made herself a plate and sat at a table with her bunk mates.

"Has anyone seen Catra?" She said as she looked around the table. Her bunk mates shook their heads and continued on with their conversations.

Adora knew asking them would be a waste. They didn't care for Catra much, so why would they know her where abouts? Adora searched across the dinning hall again but this time her eyes landed on Shadow Weaver's narrow ones. Adora quickly lowered her head and continued eating her breakfast.

A few minutes later breakfast was over. Thankfully Adora managed to keep her head down and slip past Shadow Weaver on her way to the locker room.

Unfortunately she couldn't avoid her during training. Shadow Weaver watched every single move she made. Every breath she drew. Every mistake she made. Her lack of focus. Examined every twitch in her body. She watched and examined them making mental notes on every single thing she did wrong during that training session.

Adora couldn't focus on training. She was off. More off than usually. The headache only intensifying with each minute that

passed. The pain making it hard for her to concentrate. But even without the splitting headache, her mind would wonder to Catra. It wasn't weird that Catra wasn't at breakfast, sometimes she'd skip it to avoid Shadow Weaver's never ending glaring, which naturally always had consequences in the end, it was the fact that she was missing training that had Adora worried.

Catra never missed practice. It was her way of releasing some of the energy she had built up in the morning. It was also a way for the two of them spend some time together without Shadow Weaver getting too angry. They were able to have friendly banter without getting in trouble. Of course Shadow Weaver called Catra a distraction every chance she got, but that further motivated her to be better than Adora, which in turn made Adora train harder. Bringing out the competitive side in both cadets.

With Catra's whereabouts clogging her brain and the lack focus and motivation, she had the worst time in training, and lost all of her sparing matches against the other cadets. She even lost to Kyle, Kyle. Every time she glanced at Shadow Weaver she could see her eyes narrow.

Training was finally over and Shadow Weaver was furious. Adora could barely stand by the time it was all over. With the splitting headache and now the body aches, she just wanted to hit the showers and then head to her bunk and never wake up. But she knew that she wouldn't exit the training room without Shadow Weaver telling her how poorly she performed today.

She willed herself towards the door where Shadow Weaver stood waiting for her to approach.

"Adora, sloppy work. Very very sloppy work. Today's training was unacceptable. If we can even call it training. You were not focus, which I can not understand because Catra was not in attendance today. You had the slowest time today and you lost all of your sparing matches...."

The pounding in Adora's head become more and more unbearable the more Shadow Weaver berated her about how poorly she performed today

"Are you going to tell me why your performance was unacceptable or am I going to assume it's because you were distract, as usual? Even when she is not present, Catra still manages to distract. She probably kept you awake last night and that is why you lacked focus."

"Catra has nothing to do with this." Adora said, a little louder than she intended. Shadow Weaver's eyes narrowed.

"Adora, I just want what's best for you, and Catra is not what is best for you. She distracts you. She confuses you. I am trying to help you build a future and she is only making it harder for you to accomplish said future. So I advise you to put some distance between the two of you. Focus on what is important, becoming force captain. Today's performance showed me that you are not putting your all into becoming the force captain I know you can become. I see a lot of potential in you, but do not make me waste my time if you are not going to push yourself." She said as she raised a hand to put a hair behind Adora's ear. Then she slowly moved her hand down to Adora's chin and held it in between her index finger and thumb.

"And do not think that I did not see you arrive late for breakfast this morning. That is unacceptable. Do not make it a habit." She said as she picked Adora's head up so that she was looking at her.

"You are dismissed. Head to the dinning hall for lunch. And when you come back for afternoon training, I expect you to be focused and ready to take your training serious" Shadow Weaver let go of Adora's chin as she walked away.

Adora walked out of the training room and headed straight to the Barracks. The pain in her head making it hard for her to see. She stared at the ground as she walked to avoid the pain that would

occur if she tried looking at the lights on the Frightzone walls. All she could think about was Catra and sleeping off the mind wrenching headache.

She reached the quarters and ended up bumping into someone who was on their way out. She couldn't register who it was. Her eye sight blurry and she was unable to get her eyes to focus. But then they spoke.

"Hey watch where the hell you're going." The person said with irritation in their voice.

Adora knew that voice anywhere. She may not have been able to see clearly but she knew who they were just by the irritation in their voice. The person who has been occupying her mind since this morning. The person who Shadow Weaver had thought was derailing her training. Derailing her progress. Distracting her from her future. The only person she cared deeply about.

"Catra?"

And then ever so suddenly her body collapsed and her entire world went black.

Chapter End Notes

I hope you enjoyed this chapter. Uh I hope it wasn't to much for you. The next chapter is going to be Catra's perspective some that chapter is definitely going to be filled with angst Anyway, I hope you enjoyed and don't forget to tell a friend and tell that friend to tell another friend.

~The Guardian

Chapter 11: Aftermath (Catra)

Chapter Summary

Catra struggles to deal with the events of the previous night.

Chapter Notes

Hi wow. It's been a while. I'm super duper sorry. Honestly I have no reason to have been gone for so long. I feel like maybe I just couldn't come up with anything but here we are. Anyway I definitely don't want to leave y'all like this

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Aftermath (Catra)

Catra had been crying the all night. She watched as Adora's chest rose and fell as she breathed. She couldn't sleep, all she could hear was Adora's screams of agony. When she closed her eyes the image of Shadow Weaver standing over Adora with her hands over her temples haunted her. So she just laid there and watched Adora. She wasn't sure what would happen to Adora after Shadow Weaver erased her memories. She wanted to make sure she was alright. That she was still breathing.

Shadow Weaver was probably so proud of herself. She finally succeeded. She was finally able to drive a wedge in between her and Adora. It hurt Catra, knowing that Shadow Weaver despised her so much that she would've done anything just to have Adora become force captain. The lengths that women would go to make her feel like she wasn't worthy enough to be around Adora.

How could she put Adora through all that pain? Shadow Weaver knew Adora couldn't stand the sight of her hurting Catra. She

knew Adora would crumble and talk. Even with Catra warning her by shaking her head, Catra could see how bad it hurt Adora to see her hurt. And when Adora told the truth to Shadow Weaver, she still managed to hurt both her and Adora. She used both of their pains, both physical and emotional, to hurt the other.

Catra never thought in a million years, Shadow Weaver would physically harm Adora, let alone emotionally hurt her most promising cadet. Using Catra to emotionally manipulate her into telling her the truth. Then physically altering her mind so that she'd forget everything that happened. She could only imagine the pain her body was in.

But it wasn't just that, Shadow Weaver knew that their connection was deep, and she needed to stop it before it got deeper. Before Adora put becoming a force captain second. She couldn't have that, she'd look like a fool. She knew how much Adora cared for Catra, how she would have done anything just so she didn't have to see her in pain. And in the end Shadow Weaver succeeded in destroying the only thing that made them both happy.

Catra couldn't bare the thoughts of the pain Adora was in. She knew how bad the pain was. She had to bare it all the time. But how would it affect Adora? Adora was strong, Catra knew this, but there was only so much pain one could take.

She couldn't bare to look at Adora anymore, it hurt her too much. She needed to go for a walk, clear her head of the pain they suffered together. She also needed to come up with a way to distance herself from her. She didn't want to, but she needed to. She didn't ever want to see Adora in that kind of pain again. She couldn't see her in that pain again.

She got out of the bunk they shared and exited the Barracks. She had to clear her mind of the rushing thoughts and the images of Adora in pain.

The corridor outside of the Barracks was empty and quite, except for the low buzzing sound of an occasional robot cruising through.

There was an hour before breakfast. Catra wasn't sure if she could sit at breakfast and pretend last night didn't happen. And clearly Adora would notice something was off if she wasn't sitting with her. As she turned the corner she bumped into the very last person she wanted to see.

"What are you doing out of the Barracks?" Shadow Weaver said, looking down at her.

"Do you really think I'd be able to sleep after what you did to her?" Catra said, her hands balling up as she looked down. The memories replaying in her head.

"I do not care for your excuses. Maybe if you were not plaguing her thoughts with such deviant behavior, I would not have had to take such drastic measures. But as usual, you were being selfish. You knew that that type of behavior is frowned upon in the Horde. But you let your greedy wants and needs drag Adora down. What if another cadet would have seen the two of you? What would they think of Adora? What would they think of me, being second in command and training Adora myself? I would have looked like a fool." Shadow Weaver said, as the shadows started to creep up around them.

Catra stared at the women as she got more irritated. As the shadows around them dimmed the corridor lights. She wasn't scared, she was angry. Really angry. Adora was the one who kissed her first. Sure Catra had the same wants and desires, but she never acted on them, no matter how badly she wanted to. But of course, here Shadow Weaver was placing all the blame on her. She knew it would happen. Any time Adora did something that went against Shadow Weaver's orders or desires, it was always her fault. Even when Adora told her it was her own idea. It was the same routine.

"It was Adora's idea! She even told you it was. Why is it that whenever she tells you something was her idea you don't believe her. You always think it's my idea or me who's putting these ideas and thoughts in her head?" Catra said getting irritated.

"Is it so hard for you to believe that your precious Adora isn't as innocent as you think." She said as her hands balled up into a fist.

"I do not have time for your foolish thoughts. Adora would never have such inappropriate thoughts. It is you poisoning her. And even if she did, it does not matter now because she has no memory of the deviant behavior you both displayed." Shadow Weaver said as the shadows started to retreat. Her eyes were still narrow as she continued to hover over Catra.

"I hope you have learned your lesson. I would hate to have to erase more of her memory. Or maybe next time I will just erase you from her memory all together. So I advise you to keep that little promise you made, if you want her memory of you to stay intact." Shadow Weaver said as Catra moved back a little.

Shadow Weaver would erase Adora's memory just for her to be force captain. Catra was a huge part of Adora's memories. Adora made up most of Catra's, so she could only assume it was the same for Adora. How could she be that selfish? Adora would probably end up like a mindless drone if Shadow Weaver erased her memory of her. Catra couldn't have that happen, so the best way to avoid that was to distance herself.

Catra looked at the elder women as she stared back at her. Catra was seeping with rage. She needed to get away from her before things got out of hand. She walked past the elder. The thoughts rushing back to her head as she headed towards the dinning hall.

Catra reached the dinning hall. It was empty and dimly lit as she made her at to the back towards the kitchen. She checked to see if there was anyone inside as she slowly made her way towards the back. Lucky for her it was empty. She reached the back of the kitchen to find a display of ration bars piled on top of each other. She grabbed three of the gray kind and made her way back to the empty and dimly lit dinning hall.

Catra made her way to a table all the way in the other side of the entrance. She sat in the chair closet to the wall and facing the entrance. She could see the entire dinning hall from where she sat. She slowly ate one of the ration bars to stole. As she ate she thought about the events that led her there.

Catra had a decision to make and time was running our of time. She had 10 minutes before everyone would get up for breakfast. More importantly before Adora would get up for breakfast. She knew Adora would be in physical pain from the electricity Shadow Weaver used on her last night. Of course Adora wouldn't know why she would be in so much pain, probably blaming it on training. And naturally Catra wanted to be there to comfort her. But she had a promise to keep.

As much as she hated Shadow Weaver and loved when she made her feel stupid, she couldn't risk Adora's memories being erased. She loved her to much to subject her through that pain again. So she'd distance herself from her. She knew it was going to be hard but it was necessary.

Catra was brought out of her thoughts with the sound of pans falling to the floor from the back of the kitchen. She quickly got up from her chair and quietly made her way out of the dinning hall. She was careful not to run into any other cadets as the started to make their way to the dinning hall.

She managed to make it to an empty corridor. One she knew was fairly always empty. She needed to find somewhere to hide. She couldn't run into Shadow Weaver again. And as much as She wanted to make sure Adora was ok, she couldn't risk running into her.

She made her way down the corridor, with her eyes her focused on the floor of the hall. As she turned the corner to go down another corridor she slammed right into someone. Catra was afraid to look at the person as she picked herself up from the floor.

What if it was Shadow Weaver again? She put herself through that torture again. She knew it couldn't have been Adora because Adora rarely went straight to the dinning hall for breakfast, whether Catra was with her or not. But what if it was Lord Hordak? Her left his Sanctum, but what for some reason he feels the need to? She still couldn't find the courage to look up, until the person called her name.

"Catra?" The person said as they extended their hand to help her up. She knew that timid and soft voice anywhere.

"Oh thank the stars, it just you." She said, as she grabbed Kyle's hand and got up from the floor.

"Yea, just me." He exhaled as he dusted himself off.

"Why are you walking down random corridors and not watching where you are going?" She said as she watched him.

"Well Lonnie and Rogelio were mad at me about training yesterday because I failed, again. So I decided to take an early walk throughout the corridors" He said as he looked down at his hands.

"Mmm well breakfast has started, so you better get there before Shadow Weaver realizes that you're not there. " She said, as she started to walk past him.

"Are you not coming to breakfast?" He said with curious look. Catra stopped to look at him.

"Nah, and Kyle, make sure you don't tell anyone you saw me. Especially Adora." She said she continued walking past him.

"I promise" She heard him say as she continued walking.

She wasn't sure if Kyle would actually keep his promise but she hoped he did. Kyle wasn't really known for being a blabber mouth anyway. If anything he was known for being the complete opposite. Catra wasn't really worried in all reality.

Shadow Weaver wouldn't really care that she was missing breakfast today. She wanted her to do whatever it took to stay away from Adora, and if that meant starving then that's what she expected her to do. And she knew the other cadets didn't care about her, so naturally they wouldn't have cared about her whereabouts.

She reached the end of the corridor and found a storage closet and climbed in. She made herself comfortable and opened up a Ration Bar and slowly consumed it.

Adora, she was a different story. Adora would freak out. Not about her missing breakfast, but about her missing training. Especially because she wouldn't see a trace of Catra's presence. Adora would be ok. She was going to have to be. Catra had to start distancing herself from her. It would have to be their new normal.

Catra finished eating the ration bar and started to feel her eyes kids get heavy. She was so worried about the whole Adora situation that she hadhow exhausted she truly was. Her body was more relaxed than it had been last night as she watched Adora's breathing to make sure she was still alive. She closed her eyes and drifted off to sleep.

When she woke up she was confused for a moment, completely forgetting that she was in a storage closet. She reached the doorknob and fell out. She was still half asleep as she made her way towards The Barracks. She entered to find it empty. She came to the conclusion that it was dinner time or her bunk mates were in training.

She looked towards her bunk and her thoughts were once again consumed by the pain she saw Adora in. She sat on the bed and grabbed Adora's blanket. Stared at it for a few minutes, before bringing it close to her chest and hugging it. She felt tears fall down her face as she breathed in Adora's scent. Her mind was once again consumed by her thoughts.

Shadow Weaver was probably ecstatic to see that Catra wasn't around Adora today. She finally had her star pupils undivided attention. No Catra meant no distractions. But there was still the fact that Catra knew there was no way Adora was performing at her best. Not just because Catra wasn't there to push her, but because she knew Adora's body had to had been really sore and aching.

After a few minutes of having her thoughts consume her mind once again. Holding onto Adora's blanket for dear life, and taking in a last sniff of het scent before she got off the bunk. She morning training had to be over soon. She couldn't risk Adora seeing her. After all this effort of avoiding her. Seeing her now would defeat the whole purpose. And not only that, but it would hurt her way to much.

So she made her way to exit of the Barracks. She walked into the hallway with her head lowered to avoid anyone seeing her. Only to run into someone.

"Hey, watch where the hell you're going."

Before she could even look up she heard the voice of the person she had been avoiding all day.

"Catra?"

It was a whisper. She barely heard it. As she looked up to see her Adora started to collapse. Luckily Catra was quick enough for Adora to fall into her arms.

"Adora. Adora!"

Chapter End Notes

> Hey, hey, hey! Again super duper sorry for this wait. Honestly if you want to blame something or someone you can blame Critical Role. But I'm going to really try and finish this. I'm not making any promises though.

Chapter 12: Awake

Chapter Summary

The aftermath of Adora passing out.

Chapter Notes

Hello everybody! I am sorry I have been gone for so long. writing is really hard y'all but fanfic writing is even harder.

TW: SELF HARM

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Awake

"Adora, Adora!"

All Adora could remember was hearing Catra yell her name as everything went completely dark. It hurt her. Hearing Catra calling out her name like that, and not being able to do anything about it.

"Catra!" Adora yelled as she shot up from the bed she was laying in.

Bright white walls, almost blinding, is all she could see, as she slowly tried to take in her surroundings.

As her eyes adjusted as she realized she was in the infirmary. And she wasn't alone. She could feel someone's presence. How did she get there?

"Adora." Shadow Weaver said as she watched her trying to figure out where she was.

All Adora could think about was Catra. Where was she? She hadn't seen her all day. She was scared Shadow Weaver had done something to her. And if she heard Catra before she blacked out, where was she now? Adora knew asking Shadow Weaver about Catra's whereabouts would just make her angry. She just needed to know.

"Where's Catra?" Adora said, as her eyes adjusted and landed on Shadow Weaver's already irritated face.

"Adora, there are more important things for you to worry about. This is just a minor setback. Once you get better, you must continue your training. You do still want to be the best Force Captain in all of the Horde right?" She said, as she raised her hand to stroke Adora's face.

“Besides,” she continued. “Catra is nothing but a distraction. She does not have the same potential in her that I see in you. Catra only cares about herself. Unlike her I have your best interest at heart.”

“I don’t care. I want to see her. I want to make sure she’s ok. I need her to know that I’m ok. I was looking for her yesterday and I couldn’t find her.” Adora said, as she pulled away from Shadow Weaver’s touch.

“Adora! You must stay focused. Besides, Catra is otherwise occupied with training.” She said, with narrowed eyes.

“I just want to make sure she’s ok.” Adora said, laying her head back down on the pillow.

“She is fine, Adora. Since you seemed to be so worried about Catra and her whereabouts I will be expecting you at afternoon training. You have already missed out on enough. Do not be late.” Shadow Weaver said, as she walked away from Adora’s side and exited the infirmary.

Adora stared up at the ceiling feeling her heavy eyes close and letting the darkness take over.

By the time she woke up, afternoon training was only half an hour away. Adora had a choice to make. She could head to practice, still feeling a little woozy. Or she could blow it off and deal with Shadow Weaver.

What would happen if she blew off training? The worst of it would be having Shadow Weaver disappointed in her. But she’d be well rested. Another plus would be that she wouldn’t have to deal with her for the rest of the day. But Shadow Weaver would definitely have her doing extra training. She’d be more tired than she was right now.

She didn’t want to have to deal with the consequences of missing more training. So she mustered up some strength, got dressed and made her way to the training room.

She walked. The slowest she could walk to the training room. Her head still hurting but not as bad as before she blacked out. A plus side to going to training wasa that she could run into Catra and ask her what happened. She needed to know what happened. Where she had been all day.

She reached the training room with a minute to spare. Shadow Weaver was waiting for her at the entrance.

"I knew you would make the right decision. Now fall in and let us begin." Shadow Weaver said, as Adora entered.

Adora walked in and immediately searched for Catra. It took her a while to notice her because her eyes were still adjusting to the bright lights around her. But there she was. Like nothing had happened. She was just standing there not speaking to anyone. Shadow Weaver walked in and stood in the middle of the circle of cadets.

"Today's training will be sparring. I expect no mercy today." Shadow Weaver said, looking directly at Adora.

"Now, begin." She said as two cadets entered the middle of the circle.

Fight after fight. Knock out after knock out. And Catra still hadn't spared with anyone.

Training was almost over and Adora hadn't been able to say one word to Catra. Was she avoiding her? She was going to get to the bottom of whatever was going on and the best way to do that was sparring practice.

Adora had to make sure she spared with Catra. She didn't care if Shadow Weaver got upset or she was displeased, she had to know what was going on. So after everyone had had a chance to spar with someone, Adora took the opportunity to grab Catra and drag her to the middle of the sparring circle.

“Adora, what are you doing?” Catra said, as she tried to pull away.

“Catra please. You haven’t spared with anyone and neither have I. Shadow Weaver can’t get mad at you if it’s training. So let’s go.” Adora said, still dragging her into the middle of the circle.

The first round was over within a couple of seconds. Adora wasn’t able to get one hit in before Catra knocked her to the ground.

Adora looked back at Shadow Weaver who’s eyes were narrowed slits.

She looked back at Catra who had her hand extended to help her up.

“Catra what the hell? What’s wrong with you?” She said, as she grabbed her hand.

Catra went back to the middle of the circle and waited for Adora to approach for the second round.

The final two rounds went the same way the first did, and Shadow Weaver was not pleased.

“Enough! Training is over. Adora stay behind.” Shadow Weaver said, as the other cadets exited the training room.

Adora approached her. She watched as Catra exited the room. Adora could feel Shadow Weaver’s eyes glaring at her.

“You are not taking training serious. I will not stand here and have you make me look like a fool. You could have easily taken Catra down several times. There were several opportunities. Adora, am I wasting my time? Do you not want to be a Force Captain?” Shadow Weaver said, staring at her.

“No Shadow Weaver. I want to become Force Captain. I just have a really bad headache. It started yesterday and I think it’s the

reason why I wasn't doing my best." Adora said, as she looked past Shadow Weaver in the direction of where Catra went.

"Adora, do not let her distract you. You may leave. Make sure you are better prepared for training tomorrow morning." Shadow Weaver said, as Adora exited the room.

Adora practically ran to the locker room to find Catra. Lucky for her Catra was waiting for her in front of her locker.

"Catra." Adora said out of breath as she approached her.

"Adora. Look I'm." She exhaled

"Catra, what happened? All I remember is you yelling my name before everything went black." She said as she sat on the bench in front of her locker.

"I don't know what happened. All I know is that I was leaving the Barracks and you were about to walk in and then you called my name and then passed out." Catra said, looking down at the floor.

"All I remember is having a very painful headache. What happened to you yesterday? I was looking for you everywhere and I couldn't find you." Adora said, trying to look into Catra's eyes.

Catra continued looking down at the ground. Adora was getting frustrated. It wasn't fair that she couldn't find Catra at all the previous day and now that she had, she isn't giving her any information on what was going on.

"Catra." She said, reaching out to grab her hand.

"What is going on? You haven't talked to me all day. I couldn't find you anywhere yesterday. Are you avoiding me?" Adora said, holding on to her hand.

"Why would I be avoiding you? There's no reason for me to avoid you." She said, still looking at the ground in front of her.

Adora got up from the bench and stood in front of Catra. She raised her hands to cup Catra's face as she lifted her head so they could make eye contact. Catra finally made eye contact with her and Adora could see tears in the corners of her eyes.

"Catra what's wrong? Why are you crying?" Adora said, as she wiped the tears from her eyes.

"I was so scared. You just fell and then you wouldn't wake up. What if you hadn't woken up? What was I going to do? Huh? And then I didn't know what to do. I was scared. And-."

"Hey, hey, hey. I'm alright. Don't worry. You don't need to be scared. I'm fine. And I'm pretty sure I would've woken up either way. Please don't cry." Adora said, as she continued wiping the tears from her eyes.

Adora stared into Catra's eyes for a few seconds. She didn't realize she was leaning closer to her face until she was kissing her. Catra kissed her back but pulled away after a couple of seconds.

"Adora. We can't." Catra said, pulling Adora's hands away from her face.

"We can't what? All I did was kiss you." Adora said, as she watched Catra slowly move away.

Yea and what if Shadow Weaver would've seen? Then what? You know what, forget it." Catra said, as she headed towards the exit of the locker room.

"Catra. Catra! Look, I'm sorry. Catra." She watched as Catra exited without saying another word.

Adora stood in front of her locker feeling lost. But then that loss turned into anger. She didn't understand what the big deal was. All she did was kiss her. Did Catra not feel the same way she did? Maybe she overstepped. Why was she so stupid. She had a good thing with Catra and she might've ruined it by kissing her.

“Nice work Adora.” She said to herself as she balled up her fists. She knew it was coming. She could feel it. The stress. How could she be so stupid. And what if Shadow Weaver would’ve come in or seen her. What was she thinking?

She made her way to the shower and let the water run. After making sure the water was hot enough she got in. Stared at the same wall she always ended up standing in front of when she gets stressed. The same wall she constantly took her stress out on.

The thoughts started to consume her again. She was so confused. What the hell had happened yesterday. All she wanted was to know what happened. Shadow Weaver wasn’t going to give her any information so the only person she could’ve asked was Catra. But she just fucked things up with her. Why would she do that? Kiss her. She knew she had deeper feelings for Catra but she never thought about acting on them. Catra wasn’t in the right headspace and she took advantage of that. Of her. Why was she so stupid.

She punched and punched and punched. Each punch, harder than the last one. Shadow Weaver thinking she wasn’t doing her best when she really was. She was trying. Even when she didn’t feel like it she was still putting her all into training. She wanted to be the best. She needed to be the best. She had to show Shadow Weaver that she wasn’t wasting her time.

With each thought she kept punching. This time she didn’t stop when she say the blood. She kept punching and punching. She saw the scrapes on her knuckles but continued. She felt the pain and ache but she pushed it aside and continued. And then she couldn’t feel her fingers anymore. All she could feel was intense pain running from her knuckles to her fingers. She looked down and realized her knuckles were purple, swollen and very bloody.

Oh she definitely fucked up now. She broke her knuckles. How was she going to explain what happened to Shadow Weaver? What was she going to think? Her prized pupil missing out on

training because she was stupid and allowed her emotions to get the best of her.

Adora turned off the water with her good hand and ran out of the shower and went straight to her locker. She put her clothes on as carefully as possible and rummaged through her locker to find something to wrap around her hand. She was worried about how much pain she was in. But she was more worried about what would happen if Shadow Weaver saw her with a broken hand.

After a few minutes she found a wrap and wrapped it around her knuckles. Then she quickly ran out of the locker room and headed towards the Barracks. She entered and headed straight to her bunk, where Catra was already waiting for her.

"Listen, Adora about before, I just-" Adora cut her off by covering her mouth with her good hand, while hiding her broken one behind her back.

"Let's not talk about it right now please. We can talk in the morning. Alright?"

"Okay." Catra said, looking a little skeptical.

"Okay so let's go to sleep then." Adora said, as she made her way under the covers and waited for Catra to crawl in.

Usually when they went to sleep it was Adora holding Catra, but tonight was different. Tonight Catra decided to hold Adora. This was great because it made it easy for Adora to hide her broken hand from her.

"Goodnight Adora," Catra whispered into her ear.

Goodnight Catra." Adora whispered back into her chest.

Adora let out a breath and with everything that had happened the day before, she didn't realize how tired she truly was. She slowly drifted off to sleep.

Chapter End Notes

Hey guys. Hope you enjoyed. Umm yea so like there is never a happy ending for the recent chapters. I am working on the next chapter so be prepared. It actually took me 4 days the start and finish this chapter. Anyways I know exactly how this fanfic is going to end. I don't know how many chapters it's going to have but yea. I hope you enjoyed, see you next chapter

New sign out name
~3AM_Reads

Chapter 13: Struggle

Chapter Summary

Catra struggles with her feelings and the promise she made with Shadow Weaver.

Chapter Notes

Hi. I've been gone for a month but I'm back. It was a struggle writing this chapter but I did it. I'm so happy I was able to finish it.

Also TW: self harm.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Struggle

To say Catra was struggling was the understatement of the year. She was always aware of everything and anything that had to do with Adora. Seeing Adora fall and pass out like that. The image of seeing her look so helpless and falling to the ground. She couldn't get that out of her head.

She felt so guilty. This was all her fault. Shadow Weaver wouldn't have altered her memory if she would've stopped Adora after that first night. After she kissed her. But she couldn't help herself. Adora was everything to her. It just felt so right, at the moment, with her just being there. She never would've guessed that Adora would actually kiss her.

And now after everything, Adora was hurt and she couldn't even check on her. She couldn't even see if she was conscious.

What if she never woke up? What if she lost her memory and forgot about Catra? Oh Shadow Weaver would be so happy if that

happened wouldn't she. She wouldn't have to worry about Adora being "distracted".

Of course Shadow Weaver thought she did something to her. She made a promise to stay away from Adora, so why would she hurt her. Especially because Adora was her prized pupil. She didn't know what was going to happen if Shadow Weaver saw Adora like that and she was just hovering over her.

She picked her up, the best way she could, thank god for training. She rested her head against her shoulder.

"It's going to be ok. I promise." Catra said, as she carried Adora towards the infirmary. Adora's head bobbed as Catra started to pick up her pace into a little jog.

Catra could feel her heart pounding in her ears. She was so scared. So scared that she didn't notice Shadow Weaver approaching in front of them.

"Catra! What are you doing? What did you do to her?" Shadow Weaver said, as she rushed towards them.

"I don't know what happened. I was coming out of the Barracks and she saw me. She said my name and then she just fell and hasn't woken up since." Catra said, stopping as Shadow Weaver approached.

"And where are you going now?" Shadow Weaver asked, as she loomed over them.

"I was taking her to the infirmary." Catra said.

"And do you not think that this would have been important information for me to know?" Shadow Weaver said, moving aside.

Catra didn't answer, she just walked past and continued walking towards forward. She felt Shadow Weaver following close behind.

“Do not think that this means you do not have to keep your promise. If you hadn’t distracted her with your personal desires I would not have had to alter her memory.” Shadow Weaver said, as they reached the entrance of the infirmary.

Catra entered and placed Adora down on the nearest bed. She backed up into the nearest corner, and stared at Adora as a nurse approached. Shadow Weaver approached the nurse but looked back to where Catra was standing.

“It is best that you are not here when she wakes up. For both of your sakes. You’ve already caused enough trouble. I expect to see you at training today. No excuses. And do not think that I did not notice that you missed practice yesterday. We will discuss this later. Now go, before she wakes up.” Shadow Weaver said, as she turned to the nurse.

Catra slowly made her way to the exit. Never taking her eyes off of Adora until she exited the room.

How could Shadow Weaver possibly blame her for what happened to Adora? If it was anyone’s fault it was Shadow Weaver’s. She’s the one that altered her memories. She’s the one that doesn’t want Adora around Catra. She’s the one that only ever wants to see Catra suffer. And for what? Why does she hate her so much?

Catra never understood it. Why? What did she do, for hate her so much? Why couldn’t Shadow Weaver see that she had just as much potential as Adora? She tries so fucking hard. Why can’t she ever fucking see that? Why can't she see that?

Catra felt her eyes start to burn as she made her way through the halls towards the Barracks. She was so scared. A feeling she is used to feeling thanks to Shadow Weaver.

She entered the Barracks and headed straight for the bunk they shared. She sat there for a while as her thoughts consumed her mind. She felt an episode coming.

Her hands made their way to her arms. Her claws were already extended. She couldn't take it. She needed to release the thoughts. She needed to not feel. Self doubt, never being good enough. She was just as good as Adora. No, she was better than Adora. She had just been holding back. Why was she holding back?

Her claws entered the skin on her upper arm.

It was a sharp pain but nothing she wasn't used to. But that wasn't good enough. What was so special about Adora?

She dragged her claws down her arm until she reached her elbows.

When she finally looked at her claws there was blood. Nothing new for her when she was having an episode. The gashes on her arms burned but she focused on that pain instead of the thoughts that fogged her mind.

Eventually she got up from the bunk and went to the locker room. She headed straight to the sink and cleaned up her injuries. As she cleaned up her gashes she came to a decision.

Since Shadow Weaver always overlooked her she might as well not hold back anymore. It wouldn't really matter to her. She didn't think Catra had potential anyways, but she was going to show her that Adora wasn't as talented or special as she thought she was.

It's not like she would be able to talk to Adora afterwards. She didn't have to worry about her being mad or a sore loser. She wouldn't have to get the praise she craved from her. What's one less friend when you don't have any without that one friend?

She bandaged her arms and exited the Barracks. She thought about how much she was going to miss Adora as she reached the training room.

Shadow Weaver, of course, was waiting by the entrance.

“Not that I should be telling you but, Adora is awake. You are lucky nothing serious happened to her. And I trust that you keep that promise or you know what will happen.” Shadow Weaver said, glaring down at Catra.

Catra found a spot in between two other cadets just as Adora walked in. She felt her heart skip a beat.

Thank stars she was ok. She didn’t know what she would’ve done if she wasn’t. But it’s not like she could’ve told her that. She couldn’t say anything. Not even if Shadow Weaver wasn’t around. She was going to miss her but it was for her own safety. She couldn’t see Adora like that again. She wasn’t going to risk it.

Catra could feel Adora staring at her as the sparing matches went on. She never looked at her but she knew.

The final spar was between the two of them. Somehow Catra hadn’t managed to spar with anyone and neither had Adora. And somehow Adora managed to grab her hand and drag her into the sparring circle.

The match was over within a couple of minutes. Adora being knocked down all three rounds, causing Shadow Weaver to angrily end the match. She had Adora stay behind as the rest of the cadets headed to the locker room to get ready for lights out.

This was the perfect time for her to check in on her for the last time. Shadow Weaver never came into the locker room. She’d never know she talked to her.

A few minutes later Adora came running into the locker room yelling her name.

“Catra.” She ran into the locker room out of breath.

“Adora, look I’m-“ Adora cut her off before she could finish her sentence.

She just started asking her what happened? How was she going to tell her? What was she going to tell her? How was she going to tell her Shadow Weaver altered her memory? How was she supposed to tell her the reason why? Would she even believe her?

She couldn't tell her. Shadow Weaver would find out. She found out everything.

"I don't know what happened. All I know is that I was leaving the Barracks and you were about to walk in and then you called my name and then you passed out." She lied. What else was she supposed to do? Say? It was the only option.

"All I remember is having a very painful headache. What happened to you yesterday? I was looking for you everywhere and I couldn't find you." Adora said.

Catra could feel her eyes on her. Searing into her. She knew Adora was getting irritated, not getting any answers. She had every right to be upset. But Catra was doing this for her own good. She couldn't see her crumble to the floor again. The image haunted her when she closed her eyes.

"Catra." She said, as she reached out to grab her hand.

"What is going on? You haven't talked to me all day. I couldn't find you anywhere yesterday. Are you avoiding me?" Adora said, as she held on to her hand.

"Why would I be avoiding you? There's no reason for me to avoid you." Catra said, still staring at the floor in front of her.

That was the safest place for her to look. She couldn't look Adora in the eyes and lie to her. She couldn't look into those blue eyes without breaking. So she stared at the floor

Suddenly Adora stood up in front of her and cupped her face in both hands. She lifted her head so they were making eye contact.

She couldn’t help herself. She looked into those blue eyes and fell apart. She felt tears burn her eyes.

“Catra what’s wrong? Why are you crying?” Adora said, as her hands wiped the tears from her cheeks.

“I was so scared. You just fell and then you wouldn’t wake up. What if you hadn’t woken up? What was I going to do? Huh? And then I didn’t know what to do. I was scared. And-.” Is all she could manage to get out before Adora cut her off.

“Hey, hey, hey. I’m alright. Don’t worry. You don’t need to be scared. I’m fine. And I’m pretty sure I would’ve woken up either way. Please don’t cry.” she said, wiping away more tears Catra hadn’t noticed continued to fall.

There was a silent moment. She stared into her eyes. She couldn’t help herself. They were so beautiful and blue. She was mesmerized. So mesmerized that she didn’t notice Adora leaning in until her lips were on hers.

The sweet, sweet, feeling of her lips on hers. It hadn’t been long since their last kiss, but it felt like it had been. She needed this, her lips on hers. She loved it. Then the vision of Adora crumpling to the floor flashed into her mind and she had to pull away.

“Adora. We can’t.” Catra said, pulling her hands away from her face.

“We can’t what? All I did was kiss you.” Adora said, as Catra moved away slowly. Of course Adora didn’t see the problem.

“Yea and what if Shadow Weaver would’ve seen? Then what? You know what, forget it.” She said heading towards the exit.

“Catra. Catra! Look, I'm sorry. Catra.” She heard as she left the locker room.

She exited and stood in front of the door. She leaned her back against it.

How could Adora do this to her, again! She felt a mixture of happiness and sadness. Happiness because once again Adora had kissed her first. This meant that she still had the same feelings for her. The ones she was scared to show her. But then sadness because it couldn't happen again. Not as long as Shadow Weaver was constantly watching them. Not as long as she kept her promise.

"Catra! What are you doing, just standing there?" Shadow Weaver said, startling her.

"Uh I was just heading to the Barracks." She said, looking past her.

"Where's Adora? I trust that you are keeping up on your side of the promise, right?" She said, with narrowed eyes.

"I don't know. I haven't spoken to Adora." She lied and looked down.

"Do not think that I forgot about that little display in training. You only won because Adora is still recovering from something you caused. She was not at her best. Next training she will be. Now get to the Barracks." She said, as she stared at her.

Catra slowly walked away. Occasionally she looked behind her in hopes that Adora didn't exit the locker room as Shadow Weaver was still standing there. That's all she needed, for Shadow Weaver to find out Adora was actually in the locker room and Catra had lied to her about her whereabouts. Luckily after a while Shadow Weaver walked the opposite direction, just as she reached the corner.

She entered the Barracks and stood by Adora's bunk. What the hell was she going to tell her? Adora must think she hates her when she doesn't. No, it was the complete opposite. It hurt her so much that she couldn't tell Adora how she felt. That her feelings were reciprocated. Of course Catra wanted to kiss her. She'd kiss her forever if she could. But she couldn't. Not with Shadow

Weaver reminding her about the promise they made. Not with the image of Adora on the floor non responsive. She had to make sure Adora was safe. She couldn't make her endure that pain again. Once was good enough.

A few minutes later Adora had entered the Barracks. She looked like she had done something she shouldn't have. Catra didn't want her to think she did something wrong. She hadn't. Well at least not to her.

"Listen, Adora about before, I just-" Adora cut her off by putting one hand over her mouth. Catra noticed her other hide behind her back, like she was trying to hide it. She made a mental note.

"Let's not talk about it right now please. We can talk in the morning. Alright?" Adora said, looking sad

"Okay." Catra said, looking worried.

"Okay so let's go to sleep then."

Catra watched as Adora crawled into the bunk and waited for her. Catra crawled in and open her arms so she could hold Adora. It felt like she was saying goodbye. And in a way she was.

"Goodnight Catra." Adora said into her chest.

"Goodnight Adora" Catra said, pressing a light kiss on top of her head.

It only took Adora a few minutes to fall asleep. She was clearly still exhausted from the previous day. Catra held her close and tight, not wanting to let her go. She purred a little to ease herself to sleep. She knew how much it also relaxed Adora, even while she was sleeping. Eventually she felt her eyes close and she drifted off to sleep.

Chapter End Notes

I hope you enjoyed this chapter. I’m already working on the next chapter. College really fucking up my flow y’all. Anyways don’t forget to tell a friend who can then tell their friend.

~3AM_Reads

Chapter 14: Broken

Chapter Summary

> Adora Is really going through it. Her emotions are out of control and the pain she feels from her hand is barely bearable.

Chapter Notes

> Hello. It's my birthday, so as a gift to you and myself I decided to post the second or maybe third to last chapter of my first fanfic. I hope you enjoy it.
>
> *So I'm reposting the chapter because I thought it posted the entire chapter until I actually checked. Yes I read my own work.
>
> Anyways here's the full chapter 4 months later 🤷‍♀️😭
>
> This was originally posted on May 28th.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Broken

It had only been 3 days and Adora was hurting. She had been hiding her hand from Shadow Weaver as best as she could. She hadn't seemed to notice, and if she had she didn't say anything to her. Adora knew her hand was broken. She knew. But she couldn't let Shadow Weaver find out. But training with a broken hand, how was she supposed to get away with that?

She couldn't go to the infirmary. Shadow Weaver would find out and question her about what happened. What would she say? How was she going to lie her way out of this one? She couldn't, so

she made sure to mainly put force in one hand. Thank the stars she had the most force in her left hand.

On another note, she hadn't seen Catra since that night she kissed her. When she woke up after that fateful night Catra was already gone. She didn't want Catra to avoid her. The kiss was a mistake. If that's what it took for Catra to talk to her again, then she'd lie. She'd say it didn't mean anything just to get Catra talking to her again.

But it hurt her. Knowing that she loved Catra so deeply and she couldn't even tell her. She knew Catra felt the same way. It was obvious. But something was scaring her to the point that she couldn't even be in the same room as her.

On the third day Adora couldn't take the pain. She had punched a little too hard with her right hand and practically screamed out in pain. Naturally Shadow Weaver stopped and ended training early so she could get to the bottom of what was going.

Once everyone filed out of the training room Shadow Weaver approached Adora. Looked over at her and watched as she stared at the floor avoiding eye contact with her.

"Adora, What happened?" Shadow Weaver asked, looking at her.

Adora just stared at the floor. She couldn't look at her. It hurt so much. So fucking much. She knew Shadow Weaver was going to get irritated but she couldn't. Adora was too old to be making stupid mistakes like this. It was ok when she was younger but now as a teenager, she knew she couldn't hide things from Shadow Weaver.

"Adora!" Shadow Weaver said, now looming over her. She could hear the anger in her tone.

What was she supposed to say? She couldn't mention her hand without spilling her guts about Catra. But it hurt so much. She was in so much pain. She just couldn't hold it in anymore. Her emotions got the best of her.

“My hand. I think I broke it. It hurts so much. I can’t move it. And I know. I know I should’ve said something about it sooner but, I wanted to be the best Force Captain in all of the Horde. I couldn’t let pain stop me from accomplishing that goal.” She said in between breaths. It was hard for her to get air into her lungs.

Shadow Weaver lifted Adora’s head and forced her to make eye contact with her. She could feel her eyes burning. But she wasn’t going to cry. She wasn’t. She couldn’t. Not in front of Shadow Weaver. She tried to just focus on her hand. Thinking about Catra hurt so much.

“Adora, if you were injured why would you continue training? How could you be so irresponsible? I was waiting to see how long it would take for you to tell me. I knew something was off when your performance was unacceptable. Head to the infirmary, we will discuss this later. How can you become a Force Captain with a broken hand?” Shadow Weaver said, looking her in the eyes. She didn’t wait for Adora to respond. She removed her hand from under her chin. Her head dropped and she stared at the floor again.

“Really Adora, I expected better from you. Now we have to wait until your hand heals to get back to training. Let’s hope the damage is not as severe as it seems. You are dismissed.” She said as she turned away and headed towards the exit.

Once she was alone Adora felt the burning in her eyes. This time she didn’t hold back. She let the tears fall. Of course Shadow Weaver knew. She knew everything. How could she be so stupid? She really wished Catra was there to comfort her. She hated the pressure Shadow Weaver put on her. The one thing Adora could count on was Catra being there to comfort her. But Catra was avoiding her, and it was all her fault.

She left the training room. She wanted to find Catra. Her hand could wait. It had been waiting the past 3 days, what’s one more. Catra was more important. She could withstand the physical pain

of her hand, but she couldn't stand the emotional pain she felt thinking about Catra.

She checked Catra's normal hangouts, her storage closet, the locker room. She even checked her favorite air duct and couldn't find her. There was no way Shadow Weaver was allowing Catra to skip out on training. Was she training with a different squadron just to avoid her?

Adora made her way to The Barracks. It was her only hope. She had to be there. She needed her to be there.

She practically ran to The Barracks. She rushed in, almost running into the door. Thankfully Catra was laying on the top bunk above Adora's. She was sleeping which was surprising because Catra never slept during the day.

Adora approached the bunk and climbed up to the top. She crawled in next to her. Catra was still asleep. Adora just stared at her. She watched her sleep. How could she not love her? Sure Catra had her moments where she'd let her anger get the best of her but who wouldn't. Constantly being judged by her natural instincts. But Adora loved her and all her abilities.

She watched her breath. She felt a warming in her chest when she heard her let out a little purr. She loved it when Catra purred.

Adora reached out and caressed her face, causing Catra to wake up a little startled.

"It's just me." Adora said, with her hand still on her face.

"Adora, what are you doing?" Catra said, as she slowly opened her eyes.

"I'm just laying here." She said, with her hand still caressing her face.

"Aren't you supposed to be at training or something? Does Shadow Weaver know you're here?" She said as she stared at the

ceiling.

“Are you avoiding me?” Adora asked so quietly she barely heard it come out of her own mouth.

“What?” Catra said, slowly turning to look Adora in the eyes.

“Are you avoiding me? It seems like you are. Ever since that night you haven’t said anything to me. And every time I wake up you are nowhere to be found. So I want to know if you’re avoiding me. If you want me to leave you alone then just say that. I’ll give you as much space as you want.” She said as tears started to fall down cheeks.

“Adora, don’t cry. I don’t want you to leave me alone. It's just. I’m the reason why you passed out.” Catra said, as she let out a breath and turned to look back at the ceiling.

“Adora, Shadow Weaver altered your memory so that you would forget about, well we kissed before and Shadow Weaver found out. So she got mad, altered your memory and made me promise to stay away from you.” Catra said, still staring at the ceiling.

Adora stared at her. Of course Shadow Weaver was the reason why Catra was avoiding her. Of course! If Adora wasn’t only focused on training then she was distracted. Adora’s whole life was training. She didn’t have any friends, other than Catra. And now she barely had her.

“Maybe I shouldn’t have said anything.” Catra said, still staring up at the ceiling.

“No, it’s good that you told me. At least I know that you aren’t avoiding me on purpose. You are not a distraction. In fact you are the only person that really pushes me. I need you. All the other cadets take it easy on me because they’re scared of her. You are the only one who actually challenges me. And I kissed you because I wanted to.” Adora said, turning Catra’s face so they were making eye contact.

They were silent for a while. Just staring into each other's eyes. Adora just thought about how much she cared about her. How could Shadow Weaver alter her memory to try to make her forget about the only person in all of Etheria that she cared about? How could that lady not understand that Catra was the only thing that meant more to her than training? No matter how hard Shadow Weaver tried, Adora would always love Catra.

She leaned and kissed Catra. Then she remembered the pain in her hand and pulled away.

“I broke my hand.” Adora said, with a light chuckle.

“What? Adora. How did you do that?” Catra said.

“It doesn’t matter. I was supposed to go to the infirmary to get it checked out, but I wanted to find you and figure out what was going on. Apparently Shadow Weaver knew and she was waiting to see how long it would take for me to say something.” Adora said, caressing her face.

“The good thing with a broken hand is that now I can spend more time with you. Of course without Shadow Weaver finding out.”

“Yea that’s nice and all but I think you should go and get your hand checked out. With you being such a dummy, you probably made it way worse because of training.” Catra said.

“Now go. I’ll find you later. Get your hand fixed.” She said, placing a light kiss on her now dark purple hand.

With that Adora exited The Barracks and made her way to the infirmary. To her surprise Shadow Weaver was waiting for her. Of course she was waiting for her. Where else would she be? She needed to know everything that was going on with Adora.

“Adora. What took you so long to get here? When I said head to the infirmary I meant immediately. What was so important that you disobeyed me?” Shadow Weaver said looming over her.

Adora didn’t answer. She couldn’t answer. She felt her anger start to creep up on her as Shadow Weaver questioned her. At this moment, she didn’t think it was possible but she hated Shadow Weaver. She was tired of her making Catra feel like shit. She was tired of her controlling her life.

Why couldn’t she see that she needed Catra. Catra challenged her. She was the only one who did. The other cadets were scared of Shadow Weaver. Adora wasn’t going to let Shadow Weaver stop her from spending time with Catra. She wasn’t. Even if that meant sneaking around behind her back.

“Nevermind. You have wasted enough time as it is. Let’s go.” Shadow Weaver said, bring Adora out of her thoughts. She moved to the side as Adora entered the infirmary.

Shadow Weaver hovered over Adora the entire time they were there. By the end it was confirmed, her hand was indeed broken. She wasn’t allowed to train for at least three weeks. The nurse had told Shadow Weaver that if she would have come in sooner then it probably wouldn’t have been how bad it was now. Shadow Weaver was clearly upset, but Adora couldn’t have been more happy.

Shadow Weaver pulled Adora to the side after everything was done.

“How could you be so irresponsible? Now you can’t train for at least three weeks. I thought you wanted to be a Force Captain? What were you thinking? You know what just head to The Barracks. You are no use to me like this. You are dismissed until further notice.” Shadow Weaver said, turning away and walking away.

Adora turned and headed straight for The Barracks. She was so happy. She was finally getting a break. Finally getting some time for herself. If she were being honest she deserved it. All she ever did was train. Try to meet Shadow Weaver’s impossible expectations. It didn’t matter what Adora did, it was never good

enough for Shadow Weaver. She was always doing something wrong. No matter how perfect she did something, Shadow Weaver found a flaw in it. Adora was exhausted. All she wanted to do was find Catra and lay down with her in their bunk.

"Well, looks like it's broken." She said entering The Barracks. She had a huge smile on her face. Catra was still laying in her bunk at the top when Adora walked in.

"Adora. You shouldn't be happy about that." Catra said, helping Adora up onto the bunk.

"You don't understand Catra. I'm so tired. All I do is train. I never get to have any time for myself. I have no friends, besides you. And even so she tried to pull us apart. She tried to force you to stop hanging out with me. I need this." She said as Catra opened her arms for her to crawl in.

"I get it Adora. I do. But breaking your hand on purpose." Catra said, with a sad little face.

"I mean I wasn't trying to break my hand. I just needed to let off some steam. You know how I deal with the pressure." Adora said, crawling onto the bunk.

Adora laid down in her arms. Catra wrapped her arms around her. Adora couldn't have felt any happier. There was no better feeling than Catra wrapping her arms around her. She grabbed Adora's now tightly wrapped hand and kissed it.

They laid there in silence. Adora focused on her heartbeat. After a few minutes Catra started to purr. Catra knew exactly how to help Adora relax. The purring and rumbling coming from her chest out Adora at ease. Slowly her eyes got heavy and she felt herself drifting off to sleep. And this time she didn't have to worry about training the next day.

Chapter End Notes

Honestly I haven't started on the next chapter but of course I have an idea on how it will go. It has been quite the journey with this fanfic. I started it in 2022 and it has been 2 years. I know exactly how it is going to end. Is it a happy ending? Of course not But what part of this fanfic was actually happy (Besides the second chapter). Anyways i hope you enjoyed. See you next chapter. And don't forget to tell a friend of a friend.

~3AM_Reads

Chapter 15: See You Later

Chapter Summary

> All good things must come to an end. Catra knew this. Especially now that Adora's hand had healed. But she never thought it was goodbye goodbye.

Chapter Notes

> Hello guys. I'm back for the last time on this fanfic. I hope you enjoy. This chapter is the longest one I wrote for this fanfic.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

See You Later

Things were so fucked. How could she be so stupid. Why did she let her go back to those stupid fucking woods. And for some sword she thinks she saw? Now she had Shadow Weaver breathing down her neck, questioning her about Adora's whereabouts.

She had no one else to blame but herself. She was upset, she'd admit it, she was upset that Adora made Force Captain and Shadow Weaver wasn't allowing her to go on a mission with her. So of course when Adora wanted to plan a little adventure for them she said yes. How could it had gone so wrong? Why couldn't they go back to when Adora's hand was still broken. What Catra wouldn't do to go back.

Everything was going so great while Adora was recovering from her hand. They spent so much time together. Catra could never get enough of Adora. She really couldn't. She soaked up every moment she could with her. Since Adora could only use one hand

Shadow Weaver had her, more like forced her to watch the other cadets train.

Catra could see how much Adora hated it. Not being able to let out her aggression. Shadow Weaver forced her to watch. Especially because she knew how much it hurt for her to miss out on the one thing that brought her peace. It was torture for her. The only form of peace she got was when she was with Catra, and Catra loved it.

They had never been so close. Of course they would only spend time together in The Barracks and locker room occasionally. Between stolen kisses and cuddles Catra was in heaven. But Catra could see that without physical training. Without her being able to get her aggression out she was getting restless.

But after a month of restlessness and spending as much time with Adora as she could, her hand was functional. And of course Adora wasted no time. As soon as the doctor cleared her for training she was back in the training room.

Catra was happy for her, really, she was. But if she was being honest, she was going to miss spending time with her. But it was fun while it lasted. Adora had a month worth of training to make up for, so that meant Catra wouldn't be able to spend as much time as she did when she was recovering.

By the time Adora was done with training for the day she was exhausted, but that never stopped her from waiting for Catra to finish training and fall asleep with her in her arms.

With Adora back in training Shadow Weaver was back to constantly watching her. She was back with the pressure. Catra could see how much Adora missed training but hated the amount of pressure Shadow Weaver was putting back on her. Now it was worse than before.

The first week of Adora going back to training was tourture for Catra. She had gotten so attached to Adora. Constantly having her

around. Constantly being able to receive some sort of affection from her made her feel like she was floating. But with training and them only being able to see each other before they were going to go to sleep, it felt like Catra was going through withdrawal.

After the first week things only got worse. Some nights Adora wouldn't even make it to The Barracks before Catra fell asleep. So Catra would lay awake as long as she could but eventually fall asleep without Adora.

After a while Catra had to get used to not seeing Adora as much as she used to. So she put her focus and aggression back on training. She kept herself busy. She trained from the moment she woke up to the point to where exhaustion took over.

But no matter how hard she tried. No matter how hard she tried to focus on anything other than Adora. Her mind always ended up betraying her. And even though she only occasionally saw her, Adora alway on her mind. And no matter how hard she tried to deny it, it still hurt.

How could Adora say all of that shit to her and spend all that time with her, and then just drop her when she gets better. Like she was nothing. Sure she couldn't put all the blame on Adora. They both knew how bad Shadow Weaver had it out for Catra, but the fact that Adora wasn't even trying to put up some sort of fight now. It's like what they had didn't mean anything to her. Like she didn't mean anything she had said to her that night.

And then it happened. The day Catra had to train with Adora had arrived. It had been a while since they trained together. It had been a while since the original squadron trained together. Kyle, Lonnie, and Rogelio had been placed with another squadron by order of Shadow Weaver trying to bring out the best in them. When it came to Adora, well we know how Shadow Weaver treated her. And Catra, well.

She hadn't trained with Adora in over a month. She also hadn't really spoken to Adora in the same amount of time. And not for

lack of trying either.

By the time Cara came out of her thoughts, training had already begun. Well she already knew what to expect. It was like regular training with the old squad. Something about sneaking into the Whispering Woods. Take down the princesses who guard it. The same old same old.

She snuck in hiding in one of the holographic trees. She watched as Adora gave directions. Her eyes only on Adora. She couldn't help herself.

Within the first few minutes, she watched as Kyle fell to the floor, clearly already being hit. She shook her head. Typical Kyle. The group huddled over him, clearly disappointed. But Catra's attention shifted to above the group, where they were surrounded.

"Seriously Kyle" she heard Lonnie say as they started to run.

Catra hopped from tree to tree following them as they ran. She watched as Kyle, then Rogelio and finally Lonnie got taken down. Leaving only Adora standing.

Catra watched as the Queen, which was really a gigantic robot, emerged from an open space in the floor and hovered over her. The Queen fired at her causing Adora to zig zag for an opening. When she saw it she jumped and attacked the Queen. Taking out her lasers and then stabbing the core. Pushing her back into the whole she emerged from.

Catra saw her opportunity. She approached the Queen as she was barely standing and holding on to the corners of the hole. She used her foot to push the Queen into the hole as Adora watched.

She turned around to see Adora staring back at her. The ground under her turned red and Adora fell through the floor.

She walked towards the hole. A little bit of panic settled in her stomach. To be honest she didn't know what happened when

someone fell through the floor.

She reached the hole and saw Adora hanging from her staff. She had to play it cool. She couldn't let her know she was a little panicked.

"Hey Adora, how's it hanging?" She said, leaning on her arm and smirking.

"Catra. Did you really show up late and let us do all the hard parts? That is low even for you." Adora said, with a smirk on her face.

"Aww you know nothing is too low for me. Now come on, you look stupid hanging down there." Catra said, extending her hand to help her out of the hole.

She climbed out of the hole and they headed back to the locker room.

Catra followed close behind Adora as she headed to her locker. They made little jokes. Like how Adora probably felt betrayed at how Catra didn't help. And of course. Of course Adora had to bring up the infamous incident with the mice. It happened one time. And Adora will never let her forget it.

Any type of joy or light that was present slowly dimmed at the arrival of Shadow Weaver. Catra watched as she approached her and Catra. And of course Shadow Weaver was there to praise Adora. And naturally reprimand Catra.

Shadow Weaver pulled Adora away and walked out of the locker room leaving Catra alone in front of Adora's locker.

It was like nothing had changed. There was Catra, by herself, Shadow Weaver dragging Adora away from her. As usual. Trying to keep them as far apart as possible. And as usual Catra is waiting for her to come back.

She waited an hour before going to find Adora. She didn't want to run into her while she was still with Shadow Weaver. Stars know what Shadow Weaver would do if Catra disturbed them. Shadow Weaver wouldn't have hesitated to embarrass her in front of Adora. And Adora being the people pleaser she was would've tried to defend her only to make it worse.

Catra found Adora on a balcony. Looking something in her hands. This was the perfect opportunity. She rarely caught Adora off guard. Catra pounced on her. Causing her to drop whatever she had in her hand. Thank the stars for Catra's catlike reflexes. She caught whatever she was holding in her hand midair.

"What's this?" Catra said, looking at her hands.

"Hey, give that back." Adora said, grabbing at Catra.

"No way! You've been promoted!" Catra said, on top of a pipe.

"Well kind of. I mean, yea. I guess. But it's not a big deal."

"Are you kidding? That is awesome! We're gonna see the world. And conquer it. Adora, I need to blow something up." Catra said, with excitement in her eyes.

"Shadow Weaver says you're not coming." Adora said, nervously.

"What? What is her problem with me?" Catra said.

"Well you are kind of disrespectful."

Catra tuned Adora out. What was Shadow Weaver's problem with her? Sure Catra showed up last minute for training, but everyone knew that Catra could've completed that damn course on her own with her eyes closed.

"I was hoping you could be, I don't know, happy for me." Adora said looking a little disappointed.

“Urg whatever. It’s not like I even care. I just wanna get out of this dump at some point before I die of boredom.” Catra said dramatically.

And somehow that convinced Adora enough to “borrow” a skiff and help out to explore what was out there.

Catra couldn’t believe it. They were outside of the Frightzone. Away from Shadow Weaver. Just the two of them. Alone. Was it really that easy? To just leave with her to explore outside of the Horde?

Catra was excited. A little too excited. She wanted a turn to drive the skiff. It was only fair. Adora had driven them out of the Frightzone, why couldn’t she steer the rest of the way.

Turns out that was a big mistake. You know, being how she didn’t actually know how to drive a skiff. Causing the skiff to lose control and knocking Adora out and Catra driving off.

Catra started freaking out. She managed to stop the skiff and hop off.

“Fuck. Damn it Catra. Why did you have to get so excited? Knowing that you have no idea how a skiff works. And what if you can’t find Adora. Oh god, Shadow Weaver is going to fucking kill me.” Catra said, freaking out.

She had to find Adora. She had to. Shadow Weaver would kill her if she couldn’t find her.

She stumbled through the woods. Speckles of light, lighting her way. She had no idea where the fuck she was.

She walked and walked. She didn’t know how long she had walked until she finally found Adora. Laying against a root. Unconscious.

“Shit, shit, shit. Please, please don’t be dead. PLEASE!” Catra yelled.

She walked up to Adora's unconscious body.

"Adora. Adora." She said, in her face.

Adora slowly opened her eyes.

"Adora. Are you okay? You fell out of the skiff after driving it into a tree."

"No, you drove it into a tree." Adora said, pushing Adora away.

"Up for debate. Come on, let's get out of here." Catra said, getting up.

"Wait, you didn't see it? The bright light."

"What light? Oh no please tell me you're not brain damaged. Shadow Weaver is going to kill me." Catra said, grabbing Adora's face.

"I'm not brain damaged." She said, pushing her hands away.

"Ok then let's get out of here." Catra said as she headed back towards the skiff.

The ride back was silent. Adora spent most of it looking over her shoulder. She seemed paranoid and Catra was feeling a little bit nervous.

They arrived in the Frightzone just in time for dinner. Catra followed Adora to the dining hall. She kept a close eye on her. Making sure she wasn't acting weirder than usual.

She tried to make sure they were never around Shadow Weaver. At least until lights out, which thank the stars came quickly.

Catra and Adora got ready for lights out in complete silence. Catra continued watching her. Closely. Just to make sure everything was fine. Catra was kind of freaking out now.

"Adora, are you ok?" She said, invading her personal space again.

“I’m fine.” Adora said, placing a small kiss on the corner of Catra’s lips.

Catra blushed. Adora hadn't given her a kiss in a while. Not since her hand injury. But this kiss felt different. Not like their normal ones. Like it was a message Catra couldn’t understand.

They headed to the barracks. Catra decided to lay towards Adora’s feet. Just to keep an eye on her.

Some time during the middle of the night Adora started thrashing around. Catra pretended to be asleep as she jumped awake. She heard Adora get out of their bunk and through a peaked eye watched as she headed towards the exit of the Barracks. She followed behind her as she exited.

“Hey where are you going?” Catra said.

“Back to the woods. I know I saw something out there.”

“Sounds good.” Catra said, with a little excitement.

“No. I don’t want you to get in trouble because of me. Just cover for me. I’ll be back before anyone knows I’m gone.” Adora said, leaving Catra behind.

Yea cover for her. Now she has Shadow Weaver on her back. Questioning her on her whereabouts. In all honesty Catra only knew she was in the woods. She knew nothing else.

Adora had left her with a kiss and no other explanation. Little did Catra know they would see each other again. But this time things would be different and there was no going back after.

Chapter End Notes

> Hello. It was a fun rollercoaster of feelings. There were ups and there were downs. I loved every moment of it. This isn’t goodbye, it’s see you later. This bad boy has been out since 2022 and I thought it was time to put her to bed. I hope you

enjoyed this ride with me. And stay tune to more shera fanfics. Love y’all

~3amreads

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